

HSPT Exam Simulator

Full-Length Practice Exam 06

Complete printable test with 298 multiple-choice questions, answer key, and detailed explanations.

Section	Questions	Time
Verbal Skills	60	20 minutes
Quantitative Skills	52	35 minutes
Reading Comprehension	62	35 minutes
Mathematics	64	45 minutes
Language	60	30 minutes

General Directions

Work through each section within the recommended time. Choose the best answer for every question. Mark one answer (A-D) for each item. Use the answer key and explanations only after completing the test.

Recommended total testing time: 165 minutes. Calculators should be used only when permitted by the rules followed for your HSPT preparation.

Section 1: Verbal Skills

60 questions | Recommended time: 20 minutes

1. Which word is closest in meaning to dormant?

- A) narrow
- B) noisy
- C) polished
- D) inactive

2. Which word is closest in meaning to scrutinize?

- A) examine
- B) postpone
- C) transport
- D) imitate

3. Which word is closest in meaning to versatile?

- A) adaptable
- B) temporary
- C) stubborn
- D) expensive

4. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to amplify?

- A) repeat
- B) describe
- C) reduce
- D) measure

5. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to barren?

- A) rocky
- B) remote
- C) fertile
- D) level

6. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to sporadic?

- A) unusual
- B) brief
- C) delayed
- D) continuous

7. Sapling is to tree as foal is to ____.

- A) herd
- B) pasture
- C) stable
- D) horse

8. Friction is to heat as evaporation is to ____.

- A) vapor
- B) liquid
- C) motion
- D) pressure

9. Scabbard is to sword as sheath is to ____.

- A) knife
- B) rope
- C) handle
- D) shield

10. Which word does not belong with the others?

- A) sonnet
- B) paragraph
- C) limerick
- D) haiku

11. Cedar, spruce, and fir belong to the same group. Which word belongs with them?

- A) maple
- B) elm
- C) willow
- D) pine

12. Which word does not belong with the others?

- A) altitude
- B) rainfall
- C) longitude
- D) latitude

13. Every bronze token is numbered. No numbered object is blank. Which conclusion must be true?

- A) No bronze token is blank.
- B) Every numbered object is bronze.
- C) Some blank objects are tokens.
- D) All tokens are bronze.

14. Four folders, J, K, L, and M, are stacked. J is above L. M is below K but above J. Which folder must be on top?

- A) J
- B) M
- C) L
- D) K

15. A workshop offers ceramics only on Tuesday or Thursday. Lina cannot attend Thursday. If Lina attends ceramics, which statement must be true?

- A) The workshop is canceled Thursday.
- B) Lina attends two workshops.
- C) Lina attends ceramics Tuesday.
- D) Ceramics is offered only Tuesday.

16. Which word is closest in meaning to plausible?

- A) unfinished
- B) believable
- C) enormous
- D) accidental

17. Which word is closest in meaning to hinder?

- A) approve
- B) calculate
- C) celebrate
- D) obstruct

18. Which word is closest in meaning to obsolete?

- A) flexible
- B) expensive
- C) outdated
- D) accurate

19. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to cautious?

- A) patient
- B) reckless
- C) quiet
- D) alert

20. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to scarce?

- A) hidden
- B) abundant
- C) costly
- D) distant

21. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to intricate?

- A) simple
- B) complex
- C) decorative
- D) unusual

22. Composer is to symphony as architect is to ____.

- A) blueprint
- B) ruler
- C) building
- D) office

23. Hunger is to food as fatigue is to ____.

- A) rest
- B) exercise
- C) medicine
- D) travel

24. Chapter is to novel as movement is to ____.

- A) painting
- B) symphony
- C) theater
- D) audience

25. Which word does not belong with the others?

- A) copper
- B) iron
- C) limestone
- D) silver

26. Telescope, microscope, and binoculars belong to the same group. Which item belongs with them?

- A) magnifying glass
- B) thermometer
- C) compass
- D) stopwatch

27. Which word does not belong with the others?

- A) whisper
- B) murmur
- C) shout
- D) mutter

28. If a package is fragile, it receives a red label. This package does not have a red label. What must be true?

- A) The package is not fragile.
- B) The package was delivered late.
- C) The package is heavy.
- D) The package has a blue label.

29. Three presentations, R, S, and T, are scheduled one after another. R must occur before T. S cannot be first. Which presentation must be first?

- A) T
- B) S
- C) R
- D) It cannot be determined.

30. All orchids in a greenhouse are tagged. Some tagged plants require shade. Which conclusion is guaranteed?

- A) All shaded plants are orchids.
- B) Every orchid has a tag.
- C) No orchids require shade.
- D) Some orchids require shade.

31. Which word is closest in meaning to meticulous?

- A) thorough
- B) careless
- C) ordinary
- D) rapid

32. Which word is closest in meaning to resilient?

- A) fragile
- B) hidden
- C) unchanging
- D) able to recover

33. Which word is closest in meaning to relinquish?

- A) decorate
- B) predict
- C) surrender
- D) assemble

34. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to rigid?

- A) heavy
- B) flexible
- C) exact
- D) vertical

35. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to scarce?

- A) useful
- B) hidden
- C) costly
- D) abundant

36. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to transparent?

- A) colorless
- B) fragile
- C) smooth
- D) opaque

37. Compass is to direction as thermometer is to ____.

- A) weather
- B) mercury
- C) temperature
- D) measurement

38. Wool is to sweater as clay is to ____.

- A) pottery
- B) kiln
- C) soil
- D) sculptor

39. Orchestra is to musician as fleet is to ____.

- A) voyage
- B) harbor
- C) captain
- D) ship

40. Which word does not belong with the others?

- A) bay
- B) cove
- C) plateau
- D) inlet

41. Kiln, furnace, and oven belong to the same group. Which word belongs with them?

- A) freezer
- B) heater
- C) basin
- D) cabinet

42. Which word does not belong with the others?

- A) prologue
- B) chapter
- C) telescope
- D) epilogue

43. All amber boxes are sealed. Some sealed boxes are stored upstairs. Which statement must be true?

- A) Every sealed box is amber.
- B) Some amber boxes are upstairs.
- C) No amber boxes are upstairs.
- D) Every amber box is sealed.

44. Five speakers, J, K, L, M, and N, present once each. K presents immediately after J. L presents before J. N presents after K. Which speaker cannot present first?

- A) J
- B) N
- C) L
- D) M

45. A display must contain exactly one item from each pair: red or blue, glass or wood, round or square. If the display is blue and not glass, which combination must it contain?

- A) red, wood, round
- B) blue, glass, square
- C) red, glass, round
- D) blue, wood, round or square

46. Which word is closest in meaning to prudent?

- A) cautious
- B) noisy
- C) temporary
- D) generous

47. Which word is closest in meaning to concise?

- A) cheerful
- B) uncertain
- C) brief
- D) complex

48. Which word is closest in meaning to hinder?

- A) observe
- B) delay
- C) divide
- D) praise

49. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to vacant?

- A) distant
- B) narrow
- C) occupied
- D) polished

50. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to artificial?

- A) useful
- B) colorful
- C) expensive
- D) natural

51. Which word is most nearly opposite in meaning to diminish?

- A) conceal
- B) increase
- C) measure
- D) remove

52. Mason is to trowel as barber is to ____.

- A) mirror
- B) chair
- C) scissors
- D) customer

53. Bud is to flower as caterpillar is to ____.

- A) butterfly
- B) leaf
- C) cocoon
- D) wing

54. Reservoir is to water as silo is to ____.

- A) metal
- B) farm
- C) tower
- D) grain

55. Which word does not belong with the others?

- A) elm
- B) tulip
- C) cedar
- D) maple

56. Invoice, receipt, and bill belong to the same group. Which word belongs with them?

- A) payment record
- B) envelope
- C) calendar
- D) document

57. Which word does not belong with the others?

- A) shout
- B) whisper
- C) murmur
- D) mutter

58. A workshop has four stations: P, Q, R, and S. P must be used before R. S must be used immediately before Q. Which order could be valid?

- A) S, P, R, Q
- B) R, P, S, Q
- C) Q, S, P, R
- D) P, S, Q, R

59. If the library is open, the front lights are on. The front lights are not on. Which conclusion must be true?

- A) The library is crowded.
- B) The library is not open.
- C) The library has no electricity.
- D) The library will open later.

60. Four folders—green, orange, purple, and white—are placed in a row. Purple is somewhere left of green. White is not at either end. Orange is immediately right of white. Which folder must be at the right end?

- A) orange
- B) green
- C) white
- D) purple

Section 2: Quantitative Skills

52 questions | Recommended time: 35 minutes

61. What number comes next? 3, 8, 18, 38, 78, ____

- A) 118
- B) 160
- C) 156
- D) 158

62. What number comes next? 90, 81, 73, 66, 60, ____

- A) 56
- B) 54
- C) 55
- D) 53

63. What number comes next? 2, 5, 4, 10, 8, 20, 16, ____

- A) 24
- B) 40
- C) 30
- D) 32

64. What number comes next? $\frac{1}{2}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, 1, $1\frac{1}{4}$, ____

- A) $1\frac{1}{3}$
- B) $1\frac{2}{3}$
- C) $1\frac{1}{2}$
- D) 2

65. A number is multiplied by 3, then 7 is subtracted. The result is 29. What is the original number?

- A) 10
- B) 16
- C) 14
- D) 12

66. Which value is equivalent to 35% of 80?

- A) 24
- B) 30
- C) 28
- D) 32

67. If 5 identical containers hold 17.5 liters altogether, how many liters does each container hold?

- A) 2.5
- B) 3.5
- C) 4.5
- D) 5.5

68. Quantity A: $\frac{5}{8}$ of 48

Quantity B: 40% of 80

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

69. Quantity A: The greatest common factor of 18 and 30

Quantity B: The least prime number greater than 5

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) Quantity B is greater.

70. Quantity A: x

Quantity B: 12

Given that $3x + 6 = 42$.

- A) The two quantities are equal.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) Quantity A is greater.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

71. Quantity A: The area of a square with side length 7 cm

Quantity B: The area of a rectangle 6 cm long and 8 cm wide

- A) The two quantities are equal.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) Quantity A is greater.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

72. Quantity A: The perimeter of an equilateral triangle with side length 9 cm

Quantity B: The circumference of a circle with diameter 9 cm, using $\pi \approx 3.14$

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

73. Quantity A: The third angle of a triangle whose other angles measure 47° and 68°

Quantity B: 65°

- A) The two quantities are equal.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) Quantity A is greater.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

74. What number comes next? 4, 7, 13, 22, 34, _____

- A) 49
- B) 46
- C) 52
- D) 55

75. What number comes next? 96, 48, 24, 12, ____

- A) 8
- B) 4
- C) 6
- D) 3

76. What number comes next? 5, 9, 8, 12, 11, 15, ____

- A) 14
- B) 16
- C) 13
- D) 19

77. Which number leaves a remainder of 2 when divided by 5?

- A) 53
- B) 45
- C) 50
- D) 42

78. The ratio of red beads to blue beads is 3:5. If there are 25 blue beads, how many red beads are there?

- A) 10
- B) 15
- C) 20
- D) 30

79. Which expression has the same value as $6 \times (14 - 9)$?

- A) $6 \times 14 - 6 \times 9$
- B) $6 \times 14 - 9$
- C) $84 - 9$
- D) $14 - 6 \times 9$

80. A number is increased by 20% and becomes 54. What was the original number?

- A) 46
- B) 43
- C) 45
- D) 48

81. Quantity A: $\frac{3}{5}$ of 70

Quantity B: $7^2 - 8$

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

82. Quantity A: $|-14|$

Quantity B: $\sqrt{196}$

- A) The two quantities are equal.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) Quantity A is greater.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

83. Quantity A: n

Quantity B: 9

Given that n is an integer greater than 6 and less than 12.

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) Quantity B is greater.

84. Quantity A: The volume of a rectangular prism measuring 2 cm by 3 cm by 8 cm

Quantity B: 50 cm^3

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) Quantity B is greater.

85. Quantity A: The diameter of a circle with radius 11 cm

Quantity B: 20 cm

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

86. Quantity A: The area of a triangle with base 12 cm and height 7 cm

Quantity B: The area of a parallelogram with base 7 cm and height 6 cm

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.
- D) The two quantities are equal.

87. What number comes next? 4, 7, 13, 22, 34, ____

- A) 46
- B) 49
- C) 47
- D) 52

88. What number comes next? 4, 7, 14, 17, 34, 37, ____

- A) 40
- B) 74
- C) 68
- D) 77

89. What number comes next? 5, 15, 14, 42, 41, ____

- A) 82
- B) 120
- C) 122
- D) 123

90. What number comes next? 1, 4, 10, 19, 31, ____

- A) 46
- B) 44
- C) 45
- D) 43

91. A number is increased by 25%, producing 90. What was the original number?

- A) 68
- B) 75
- C) 72
- D) 80

92. Which fraction is equivalent to 0.375?

- A) $\frac{3}{5}$
- B) $\frac{5}{16}$
- C) $\frac{7}{20}$
- D) $\frac{3}{8}$

93. If the ratio of red beads to blue beads is 7:4 and there are 28 red beads, how many blue beads are there?

- A) 12
- B) 14
- C) 18
- D) 16

94. Quantity A: $\frac{3}{5}$ of 70

Quantity B: $7^2 - 8$

- A) Quantity B is greater.
- B) Quantity A is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

95. Quantity A: The value of n if $2n + 5 = 23$

Quantity B: 10

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) The two quantities are equal.
- C) Quantity B is greater.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

96. Quantity A: The number of positive factors of 18

Quantity B: 6

- A) The two quantities are equal.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) Quantity A is greater.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

97. Quantity A: The area of a triangle with base 12 cm and height 7 cm

Quantity B: 40 cm²

- A) Quantity B is greater.
- B) Quantity A is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

98. Quantity A: The volume of a cube with edge length 4 cm

Quantity B: 64 cm³

- A) The two quantities are equal.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) Quantity A is greater.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

99. Quantity A: The perimeter of a rectangle with length 11 cm and width 5 cm

Quantity B: The perimeter of a square with side length 8 cm

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

100. What number comes next? 2, 6, 18, 54, ____

- A) 108
- B) 216
- C) 162
- D) 324

101. What number comes next? 81, 72, 64, 57, 51, ____

- A) 44
- B) 47
- C) 45
- D) 46

102. What number comes next? 3, 4, 8, 9, 18, 19, ____

- A) 20
- B) 38
- C) 36
- D) 37

103. A price of \$80 is reduced by 15%. What is the new price?

- A) \$70
- B) \$65
- C) \$68
- D) \$72

104. Which number is divisible by both 6 and 9?

- A) 42
- B) 72
- C) 54
- D) 90

105. If 5 notebooks cost \$13.75 at the same price per notebook, how much do 8 notebooks cost?

- A) \$22.00
- B) \$20.00
- C) \$21.50
- D) \$22.75

106. A number divided by 4, then increased by 7, equals 16. What is the number?

- A) 28
- B) 32
- C) 40
- D) 36

107. Quantity A: 35% of 80

Quantity B: 30% of 90

- A) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) Quantity A is greater.

108. Quantity A: x , where $3x - 4 = 20$

Quantity B: 7

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

109. Quantity A: The remainder when 47 is divided by 6

Quantity B: The remainder when 38 is divided by 5

- A) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) Quantity A is greater.

110. Quantity A: The circumference of a circle with diameter 10 cm

Quantity B: The circumference of a circle with radius 5 cm

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) The two quantities are equal.
- C) Quantity B is greater.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

111. Quantity A: The area of a square with perimeter 28 cm

Quantity B: 50 cm^2

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

112. Quantity A: The third angle of a triangle whose other angles are 48° and 67°

Quantity B: 65°

- A) Quantity A is greater.
- B) Quantity B is greater.
- C) The two quantities are equal.
- D) The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

Section 3: Reading Comprehension

62 questions | Recommended time: 35 minutes

Literary Passage: The Bell in the Fog

Mara had crossed the harbor footbridge hundreds of times, but never before sunrise. That morning, fog covered the water so completely that the fishing boats below seemed to have disappeared. She was carrying a repaired brass bell to her grandfather's small ferry, which was scheduled to make its first trip at six.

Halfway across the bridge, Mara heard a faint metallic sound from somewhere ahead. She stopped. Another ring followed, then two quick ones. It was not the bell she carried; that bell was wrapped tightly in cloth.

Mara remembered her grandfather explaining that boat crews sometimes rang bells when visibility was poor. She moved to the railing and listened. The ringing came again, closer now. Moments later, the dark outline of a small sailboat emerged beneath the bridge. Its pilot was moving slowly, using sound to warn other vessels.

By the time Mara reached the ferry dock, the fog had begun to thin. Her grandfather unwrapped the repaired bell and fastened it beside the wheel. "Good timing," he said.

Mara looked toward the pale harbor. Until that morning, she had thought of a bell mainly as something that announced an arrival. Now she understood that sometimes a sound mattered most because it helped people move safely through what they could not see.

113. Why does Mara know that the first ringing sound does not come from the bell she is carrying?

- A) Her bell is wrapped tightly in cloth.
- B) Her grandfather has already installed it.
- C) The sound comes from behind her.
- D) Her bell is made of a different metal.

114. What can most reasonably be inferred about the sailboat pilot?

- A) The pilot is unfamiliar with the harbor.
- B) The pilot is trying to attract Mara's attention.
- C) The pilot is taking precautions because visibility is limited.
- D) The pilot is waiting for the ferry to depart.

115. As used in the passage, "faint" most nearly means

- A) unpleasant.
- B) repeated.
- C) difficult to hear.
- D) unusually high.

116. Mara's changing understanding of the bell mainly serves to

- A) reveal how an ordinary object gains new meaning for her.
- B) create uncertainty about the sailboat.
- C) show that Mara dislikes traveling in fog.
- D) explain why the ferry needs repairs.

117. Which statement best expresses a central idea of the passage?

- A) Harbors are safest when only a few boats are moving.
- B) Traveling before sunrise is usually more difficult than expected.
- C) Older equipment is often more dependable than newer equipment.
- D) Familiar things can take on greater meaning when their purpose is understood.

Informational Passage: How Desert Pavement Forms

Some desert surfaces look as though workers carefully covered them with closely fitted stones. This natural covering is called desert pavement. It can stretch across broad areas, leaving little exposed sand or soil between the rocks.

Scientists once thought wind created these surfaces mainly by blowing away fine particles and leaving larger stones behind. Wind does contribute, but researchers have found that the process can be more complex. In some deserts, dust settles among stones and gradually becomes part of the soil below them. Rainwater carries additional fine material downward. Meanwhile, repeated swelling and shrinking of soil can slowly move stones toward the surface.

The stones themselves also influence what happens next. Once a dense layer forms, it shields much of the finer material underneath from wind erosion. Over long periods, the exposed rocks may develop a dark coating called desert varnish, produced through interactions among minerals, dust, moisture, and microorganisms.

Desert pavement forms slowly, so an undisturbed surface can preserve evidence about environmental conditions over long spans of time. For researchers, these stony landscapes are therefore more than unusual scenery.

They can provide clues about how a desert surface has changed.

118. According to the passage, what is one effect of a dense layer of surface stones?

- A) It increases the amount of rainfall.
- B) It protects finer material beneath it from wind erosion.
- C) It prevents dust from settling.
- D) It causes microorganisms to disappear.

119. Which process can help move stones toward the surface?

- A) Continuous freezing of exposed rock
- B) Evaporation of minerals from stones
- C) Movement caused only by animals
- D) Repeated swelling and shrinking of soil

120. As used in the final paragraph, "preserve" most nearly means

- A) keep over time.
- B) explain immediately.
- C) change rapidly.
- D) hide completely.

121. How is the passage mainly organized?

- A) It compares two deserts and argues that one is older.
- B) It describes a feature, explains processes that form it, and discusses why it is useful to researchers.
- C) It presents instructions for creating a stone-covered surface.
- D) It lists several desert organisms in order of size.

122. Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

- A) Wind alone cannot explain every example of desert pavement.
- B) Desert pavement can form within a few weeks.
- C) Desert varnish always forms before the stones reach the surface.
- D) Fine soil cannot exist beneath desert pavement.

Humanities Passage: The Value of Margins

When people examine old handwritten books, they often focus first on the main text. Yet historians may be equally interested in marks along the edges of a page. A reader centuries ago might have underlined a sentence, corrected a word, drawn a symbol, or written a short reaction in the margin.

Such notes are called marginalia. They can reveal how people interacted with books rather than merely what books contained. A carefully copied definition may suggest that a reader was studying. An irritated comment beside an argument may reveal disagreement. A pointing hand drawn next to a passage might show that the reader considered those lines especially important.

Marginalia must be interpreted cautiously. A name written inside a book does not prove that the person read every page, and a mysterious mark may have several possible meanings. Researchers compare handwriting, ink, dates, and other evidence before drawing conclusions.

Even with these limits, marginal notes make reading from the past feel unexpectedly active. They remind us that books were not always silent objects resting untouched on shelves. Readers questioned them, learned from them, argued with them, and sometimes left traces of those encounters for someone else to discover centuries later.

123. According to the passage, what might a pointing hand beside a passage indicate?

- A) The reader considered the passage important.
- B) The reader wanted the passage removed.
- C) The book belonged to an artist.
- D) The page had been copied incorrectly.

124. In the final sentence, "traces" most nearly means

- A) instructions.
- B) evidence left behind.
- C) complete explanations.
- D) printed illustrations.

125. Why do researchers compare handwriting, ink, dates, and other evidence?

- A) To determine the price of every old book
- B) To erase notes added by later readers
- C) To decide which books should be rewritten
- D) To avoid making conclusions from uncertain evidence alone

126. What is the effect of describing books as "silent objects resting untouched on shelves"?

- A) It proves that old books were rarely read.
- B) It suggests that libraries were once unusually quiet.
- C) It contrasts a passive image of books with evidence of active readers.
- D) It criticizes people who write in modern books.

127. What is the author's main purpose?

- A) To teach readers how to identify valuable books
- B) To argue that all handwritten notes should be preserved
- C) To explain how marginalia can provide evidence about past readers
- D) To compare handwriting styles from different centuries

128. Which best describes the author's tone toward marginalia?

- A) interested but appropriately cautious
- B) suspicious and dismissive
- C) amused and careless
- D) frustrated and critical

Literary Passage: The Unfinished Kite

Noah had planned to spend Saturday morning testing the kite he had built from thin wooden strips and bright paper. By breakfast, however, the sky was completely still. The leaves on the maple tree outside barely moved. His younger cousin Elise studied the kite leaning against the porch wall. "Maybe it needs something else," she said.

"It needs wind," Noah replied.

Instead of waiting, Elise carried several scraps of ribbon to the table and began tying them to a short piece of string. Noah watched as she tested different lengths by pulling the string through the air. One ribbon fluttered freely while another twisted around itself.

Soon Noah joined her. They shortened the tail of the kite, changed the spacing between the ribbons, and reinforced one corner that had begun to bend. They could not test whether the kite would fly, but they could improve parts of its design.

By late afternoon, a breeze finally stirred the branches. Noah ran across the field while Elise held the kite above her head. When she released it, the kite climbed steadily instead of spinning as it had during earlier trials that week.

Noah laughed. The wind had arrived, but he realized the quiet morning had not been wasted after all.

129. What problem prevents Noah from testing the kite at the beginning of the passage?

- A) The kite has a torn corner.
- B) The field is unavailable.
- C) Elise has misplaced the string.
- D) There is almost no wind.

130. What does Elise's behavior most strongly suggest?

- A) She looks for useful work even when the original plan cannot proceed.
- B) She doubts that Noah's kite can ever fly.
- C) She prefers decorating objects to using them.
- D) She already knows exactly how long every kite tail should be.

131. The contrast between the still morning and the breezy afternoon mainly helps show

- A) how Noah uses an unexpected delay productively.
- B) why Elise dislikes windy weather.
- C) that the kite requires unusually strong wind.
- D) why the cousins decide to stop experimenting.

132. As used in the passage, "reinforced" most nearly means

- A) decorated.
- B) measured.
- C) replaced.
- D) strengthened.

133. Which statement best expresses the central idea of the passage?

- A) Outdoor projects should be postponed when weather conditions change.
- B) Younger people often understand designs better than older people.
- C) An obstacle can create an opportunity to improve a plan.
- D) A successful kite depends mainly on using decorative materials.

Scientific Passage: Why Some Seeds Wait

A seed may contain everything needed to begin a new plant, yet it does not always sprout immediately. Many seeds enter a condition called dormancy, during which growth is temporarily delayed even when the seed is alive.

Dormancy can protect a young plant from emerging at a dangerous time. For example, if a seed sprouted during a brief warm period in the middle of winter, the new shoot might be damaged when freezing temperatures returned. Some seeds therefore require a period of cold before they can germinate. Others remain inactive until enough moisture is available or until a tough outer covering has been weakened.

Fire can also influence certain seeds. In some environments, heat or chemicals released by smoke help trigger germination. This means new plants may begin growing after a fire has cleared space and reduced competition for sunlight.

Scientists who study seed dormancy examine how temperature, water, light, and chemical signals affect germination. Their work can help farmers and conservationists determine when seeds are most likely to grow successfully. Dormancy may look like inactivity, but it is often an adaptation that improves a plant's chance of beginning life under favorable conditions.

134. According to the passage, why might sprouting during a brief winter warm period be harmful?

- A) The seed would receive too much sunlight.
- B) The plant would immediately lose its outer covering.
- C) Returning freezing temperatures could damage the new growth.
- D) Smoke would prevent the seed from receiving moisture.

135. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Scientists have discovered that water prevents most seeds from becoming dormant.
- B) Seeds can grow only after experiencing cold temperatures.
- C) Farmers use fire as the main method for causing seeds to germinate.
- D) Seed dormancy delays germination until conditions may be more favorable for growth.

136. Which inference is best supported by the passage?

- A) All dormant seeds respond to the same environmental signal.
- B) Immediate germination is not always advantageous for a seed.
- C) Seeds with tough outer coverings cannot germinate naturally.
- D) Dormancy occurs only in regions with cold winters.

137. How does the author develop the explanation of seed dormancy?

- A) By arguing against several farming techniques
- B) By defining dormancy, giving examples of triggers, and explaining its advantage
- C) By comparing seeds with mature plants
- D) By presenting a chronological history of plant research

138. Which factor does the passage identify as a possible trigger for germination in some fire-adapted seeds?

- A) Increased soil depth
- B) Reduced air pressure
- C) Chemicals released by smoke
- D) Contact with mature roots

Informational Passage: Reading a Building Through Its Repairs

Old buildings are often described by the year they were constructed, but that single date can hide a much longer story. Over decades or centuries, owners repair roofs, replace windows, close doorways, add rooms, and adapt interiors to new uses. Architectural historians study these changes because alterations can reveal how people lived and what they valued.

Evidence may appear in unexpected places. A patch of differently colored brick can indicate where a doorway

once stood. Marks in wooden beams may show that a wall or staircase was moved. Layers of paint can reveal changing preferences, while nail holes or grooves may suggest the former location of shelves, signs, or partitions.

Researchers do not assume that every unusual feature has an important explanation. Materials may have been reused simply because they were available, and repairs sometimes resulted from ordinary damage rather than major changes in a building's purpose. For that reason, physical evidence is often compared with maps, photographs, receipts, or written records.

Studying repairs transforms a building from a fixed object into a record of decisions. A structure may begin as a home, later become a shop, and eventually serve as an office. The walls remain, but the evidence within them can reveal a sequence of human choices.

139. According to the passage, what might differently colored brick suggest?

- A) The building was originally painted.
- B) The bricks came from another country.
- C) The roof was replaced recently.
- D) A doorway may once have existed there.

140. What is the author's main purpose?

- A) To explain how alterations and repairs can reveal a building's history
- B) To persuade readers that old buildings should never be changed
- C) To compare modern construction with ancient construction
- D) To describe the tools used by professional builders

141. Why do researchers compare physical evidence with maps, photographs, and written records?

- A) To determine whether old materials are valuable
- B) To support or challenge interpretations of physical clues
- C) To identify the original architect in every case
- D) To calculate the exact cost of each repair

142. As used in the passage, "adapt" most nearly means

- A) preserve without change.
- B) modify for a different purpose.
- C) measure precisely.
- D) decorate carefully.

143. What is the effect of describing a building as "a record of decisions"?

- A) It suggests that buildings literally contain written reports.
- B) It implies that every repair was carefully documented.
- C) It emphasizes that physical changes can provide evidence of human choices.
- D) It shows that buildings are more reliable than written sources.

144. Which statement best summarizes the passage?

- A) Changes to buildings, interpreted alongside other evidence, can reveal how structures were used over time.
- B) Old buildings should be restored to exactly their original condition.
- C) Architectural historians mainly use paint colors to determine a building's age.
- D) Written records are usually more useful than physical evidence when studying buildings.

Literary Passage: The Unfinished Map

Nia found the map folded inside a field notebook her aunt had left on the kitchen table. It showed the narrow trails around a coastal marsh, but one section ended abruptly beside a penciled question mark. Her aunt, a wildlife

surveyor, had gone to town for supplies and would not return until evening. Nia knew the missing line was not an invitation to explore alone. Still, curiosity followed her all afternoon. When her aunt returned, Nia asked about the blank section. "That path changes," her aunt explained. "Storm tides shift the reeds and sometimes cover the ground. A line that was accurate last month might mislead someone today." The next morning, they walked toward the unfinished portion together. Instead of drawing immediately, Nia's aunt stopped often. She checked the firmness of the ground with a pole, noted water levels, and compared landmarks with older entries in the notebook. At last they reached a dry ridge that curved around a flooded patch. Nia expected her aunt to complete the map, but she drew only a short dotted line and added the date. "Why not make it permanent?" Nia asked. "Because a useful map sometimes needs to admit what may change," her aunt replied. Nia looked again at the question mark. It no longer seemed like a missing answer. It looked like useful information.

145. Why had Nia's aunt left part of the map unfinished?

- A) The ridge was outside the marsh.
- B) She had lost the notebook.
- C) She wanted Nia to finish it.
- D) The path could change after storm tides.

146. Why does Nia's aunt check the ground and water levels before drawing?

- A) She wants evidence about the route's current condition.
- B) She has forgotten where the marsh is.
- C) She is searching for a lost pole.
- D) She plans to build a new trail.

147. In the passage, "abruptly" most nearly means

- A) carefully.
- B) permanently.
- C) at a steep angle.
- D) without warning.

148. What does the question mark come to symbolize for Nia?

- A) A mistake that must be erased
- B) Her aunt's uncertainty about her job
- C) The value of acknowledging changing conditions
- D) A shortcut through the marsh

149. Which statement best expresses a central idea of the passage?

- A) Exploration is most valuable when done alone.
- B) Accurate information sometimes includes uncertainty.
- C) Maps should always show the shortest route.
- D) Old notebooks are more reliable than new observations.

Literary Passage: A Different Kind of Rehearsal

Elias had agreed to operate the lights for a neighborhood theater production because he preferred working where the audience could not see him. During rehearsals, he sat at a small control board, following numbered cues written beside the script. Two days before opening night, the actor playing the messenger lost his voice. The director scanned the room

and asked Elias to read the messenger's six lines during rehearsal so the other actors could continue practicing. Elias resisted at first. He knew every lighting cue but had never spoken from the stage. Finally, he carried the script to the empty set. His first line came out so quietly that the director asked him to repeat it. On the second attempt, Elias noticed something unexpected. The timing of the words affected when the actors crossed the stage, and their movement affected when the lights should change. Speaking the lines helped him understand why several cues had always felt rushed. The next day, another actor took over the messenger role. Elias happily returned to the control board. Yet he adjusted two cue marks in his script before rehearsal began. Opening night went smoothly. When the messenger entered under a narrow pool of light, Elias smiled. He had not discovered a secret desire to perform. Instead, briefly standing in someone else's place had made him better at the work he already wanted to do.

150. Why is Elias first asked to read the messenger's lines?

- A) The messenger actor has lost his voice.
- B) The director wants to give him a larger role.
- C) The lighting board has stopped working.
- D) Another actor has forgotten the script.

151. What does Elias learn from speaking the lines?

- A) The lighting cues are unrelated to the actors' movement.
- B) He prefers acting to technical work.
- C) Timing onstage can explain why certain lighting cues feel rushed.
- D) The script contains too many messenger scenes.

152. Why does the author emphasize that Elias happily returns to the control board?

- A) To suggest that the director criticized his acting
- B) To prove that technical work is easier than acting
- C) To explain why the messenger role was removed
- D) To show that his brief stage experience improved rather than replaced his original interest

153. Which best describes the structure of the passage?

- A) Two characters debate which theater job is harder.
- B) A problem is introduced, a character tries an unfamiliar role, and the experience changes his understanding.
- C) A series of unrelated rehearsal mistakes is listed.
- D) A technical process is explained step by step.

154. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Understanding another role can improve one's performance in a different role.
- B) Public performance is necessary for confidence.
- C) Temporary responsibilities should become permanent.
- D) Theater productions depend mainly on lighting.

Informational Passage: Why Some Bridges Use Expansion Joints

A long bridge may appear solid and motionless, but its materials are constantly responding to temperature. Steel and concrete generally expand when warmed and contract when cooled. The change in a short object may be tiny, but across a long bridge, small changes can add up. Engineers account for this movement by including features such as expansion joints. These are planned gaps or flexible connections placed between sections of a bridge. They allow neighboring sections to move slightly without pressing dangerously against one another. Expansion joints must handle more than temperature changes. Traffic repeatedly passes over them, and water,

grit, and road salt can enter the openings. For that reason, joints are designed to support vehicle loads while also allowing movement. They must also be inspected and maintained because worn components can create rough surfaces or allow water to reach structures below the roadway.

Not every bridge uses the same kind or number of joints. Engineers consider the bridge's length, materials, local climate, and structural design. In some modern bridges, designers reduce the number of joints by allowing larger portions of the structure to move together.

Expansion joints illustrate a broader engineering principle: a strong structure does not always resist every movement. Sometimes durability depends on allowing carefully controlled movement to occur.

155. What is the primary purpose of an expansion joint?

- A) To allow bridge sections to move slightly
- B) To prevent all water from reaching the roadway
- C) To increase traffic speed
- D) To make a bridge appear shorter

156. As used in the final paragraph, "controlled" most nearly means

- A) prevented completely.
- B) unexpected.
- C) carefully limited or managed.
- D) invisible.

157. Why might a bridge in a region with large temperature changes need particular attention to movement?

- A) Traffic automatically becomes heavier in changing weather.
- B) Its materials may undergo greater expansion and contraction.
- C) Concrete stops supporting weight in cold weather.
- D) Expansion joints work only in warm climates.

158. How does the third paragraph develop the passage?

- A) It compares bridges with tunnels.
- B) It argues that expansion joints should be eliminated.
- C) It describes the history of the first expansion joint.
- D) It explains additional demands placed on expansion joints and why maintenance matters.

159. Which idea best summarizes the passage?

- A) Bridge strength depends on making every component completely rigid.
- B) Engineers use planned flexibility to help bridges handle movement and remain durable.
- C) All bridges should use the same number of expansion joints.
- D) Expansion joints are decorative gaps used mainly on older bridges.

Literary Passage: The Spare Key

For months, Mateo had watched Mr. Ibarra unlock the community garden shed every Saturday morning. Inside were rakes, watering cans, gloves, and a battered toolbox. Mateo usually arrived early to help set out equipment, but he had never been responsible for opening the shed.

One Friday, Mr. Ibarra handed him a small brass key. "I have an appointment tomorrow," he said. "Could you get everyone started?"

Mateo slipped the key into his pocket, pleased by the trust it represented. The next morning, however, he discovered that the lock would not turn. He tried again, then stopped before forcing it. Several volunteers were already waiting.

Instead of pretending he knew what to do, Mateo called Mr. Ibarra. After hearing the problem, Mr. Ibarra laughed

gently. "You have the spare key for the side gate. I gave you the wrong one."
A neighbor who lived nearby brought the correct shed key. The delay lasted only fifteen minutes.
Later, Mateo apologized for interrupting the appointment. Mr. Ibarra shook his head. "You did exactly what I hoped you would do. Being responsible does not mean never having a problem. It means knowing when not to make one worse."
Mateo returned the spare key. It felt less like a symbol of authority now and more like a reminder that good judgment sometimes begins with asking for help.

160. Why does Mateo stop trying to turn the key?

- A) He notices that volunteers have left.
- B) He remembers that the shed is empty.
- C) He does not want to damage the lock.
- D) He decides the garden should remain closed.

161. What does Mr. Ibarra most likely value in Mateo's response?

- A) His willingness to hide a mistake
- B) His ability to work without other people
- C) His speed in opening the garden
- D) His judgment in seeking help before causing damage

162. In the passage, "represented" most nearly means

- A) symbolized.
- B) replaced.
- C) described aloud.
- D) measured.

163. How does the meaning of the key change for Mateo?

- A) It changes from an unwanted burden to a valuable object.
- B) It changes from a sign of trust to a reminder about responsible judgment.
- C) It changes from a mystery to proof that Mr. Ibarra is careless.
- D) It changes from a gardening tool to a family keepsake.

164. Which statement best expresses a central idea of the passage?

- A) Leadership requires solving every problem independently.
- B) Small mistakes usually have serious consequences.
- C) Responsibility includes recognizing when assistance is needed.
- D) Experience is more important than trust.

Scientific Passage: How Tree Rings Record More Than Age

Each year, many trees growing in seasonal climates add a new layer of wood beneath their bark. When a trunk is viewed in cross section, these layers often appear as rings. Counting the rings can provide an estimate of a tree's age, but researchers can learn much more from them.

The width of a ring reflects conditions that affected growth during a particular season. In some environments, plentiful moisture and favorable temperatures may produce wider rings, while drought can contribute to narrower ones. However, ring width cannot be interpreted by a single rule everywhere. Different tree species respond differently, and factors such as crowding, disease, or damage can also influence growth.

Researchers therefore compare patterns across many trees from the same region. If numerous trees show unusually narrow growth during the same period, a shared environmental cause becomes more likely. Scientists can also match overlapping ring patterns from living trees and older wood. This method can extend a regional record farther into the past than the lifespan of any one tree.

Tree-ring evidence is especially useful when combined with other records, such as historical observations or measurements from sediments. Rather than acting as a perfect diary, tree rings provide clues. Their value comes from careful comparison, context, and the recognition that several factors can leave similar marks.

165. Why do researchers compare ring patterns across many trees from the same region?

- A) To determine which tree is tallest
- B) To make a shared environmental cause easier to identify
- C) To prove that every species grows at the same rate
- D) To replace all other environmental records

166. As used in the third paragraph, “extend” most nearly means

- A) stretch the physical wood.
- B) make less accurate.
- C) divide into sections.
- D) continue farther back.

167. Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

- A) A narrow ring always proves that a drought occurred.
- B) Tree-ring evidence becomes stronger when patterns and other records agree.
- C) One tree usually provides enough evidence to reconstruct a region's past.
- D) Tree rings are useful only when the exact age of a tree is unknown.

168. How is the passage mainly organized?

- A) It presents two scientists debating whether trees grow annually.
- B) It introduces tree rings, explains how they are interpreted, and describes why comparison improves the evidence.
- C) It lists tree species from oldest to youngest.
- D) It describes a laboratory experiment in chronological order.

169. In the final paragraph, “context” most nearly refers to

- A) the color of the bark.
- B) the location of words on a page.
- C) the exact number of branches on a tree.
- D) the surrounding information needed to interpret evidence.

Biographical-Style Passage: A Workshop of Small Improvements

In the early years of public bicycle manufacturing, inventors often received attention for dramatic new designs. Yet many practical advances came from less celebrated workers who improved ordinary parts. One such fictionalized example is Clara Venn, a skilled machinist working in a small industrial shop at the turn of the twentieth century.

Venn's daily work involved shaping metal fittings used on several kinds of machines. When a local bicycle maker began ordering parts from the shop, she noticed that mechanics repeatedly filed the same bracket by hand before installation. The bracket worked, but its original shape made assembly unnecessarily slow.

Rather than proposing an entirely new bicycle, Venn changed the angle and placement of two holes in the bracket. She produced several samples, asked mechanics to test them, and adjusted the design after hearing their comments. The final version could be installed more quickly with fewer corrections.

The improvement was modest, and customers buying bicycles probably never knew about it. For the workshop, however, the change reduced wasted effort and made production more consistent.

Stories like Venn's illustrate an important feature of technological development. Progress is not always a sequence of famous inventions. It can also grow through careful observation, repeated testing, and small

changes made by people close to the work itself.

170. What problem did Venn notice with the original bracket?

- A) It broke whenever bicycles were ridden quickly.
- B) It was too expensive for the workshop to purchase.
- C) It required mechanics to make repeated adjustments before installation.
- D) It could be used only on machines other than bicycles.

171. Why does the passage mention that customers probably never knew about Venn's improvement?

- A) To emphasize that useful progress can occur without public recognition
- B) To suggest that the improvement had no practical effect
- C) To show that bicycle customers disliked technical changes
- D) To explain why the workshop stopped using the bracket

172. What role does Venn's story play in the passage?

- A) It provides a humorous contrast to modern manufacturing.
- B) It serves as an example supporting a broader idea about technological progress.
- C) It proves that one worker invented the modern bicycle.
- D) It creates suspense about whether the workshop will close.

173. Which best describes the author's tone?

- A) doubtful and sarcastic
- B) angry and accusatory
- C) admiring but measured
- D) playful and comic

174. What is the main purpose of the passage?

- A) To argue that famous inventions rarely work
- B) To explain why bicycles were difficult to manufacture
- C) To compare several competing bicycle companies
- D) To show how small, practical improvements can contribute to technological progress

Section 4: Mathematics

64 questions | Recommended time: 45 minutes

175. Which number is greatest?

- A) $\frac{7}{12}$
- B) 0.56
- C) 55%
- D) 0.57

176. What is the value of $2\frac{1}{4} \div \frac{3}{8}$?

- A) 6
- B) 5
- C) $6\frac{1}{2}$
- D) 7

177. What is the least positive number that is divisible by 8, 12, and 18?

- A) 36
- B) 48
- C) 144
- D) 72

178. A price decreases from \$64 to \$52. What is the percent decrease?

- A) 12%
- B) 15%
- C) 18.75%
- D) 16%

179. If $y = 4x - 7$, what is y when $x = 6$?

- A) 31
- B) 19
- C) 24
- D) 17

180. Which expression is equivalent to $5(2n - 3) + 4$?

- A) $10n - 11$
- B) $10n - 19$
- C) $10n + 1$
- D) $7n - 11$

181. A machine produces 18 parts in 6 minutes at a constant rate. At this rate, how many parts will it produce in 15 minutes?

- A) 36
- B) 45
- C) 42
- D) 40

182. Solve the inequality $4p - 9 > 19$.

- A) $p > 7$
- B) $p > 5$
- C) $p < 7$
- D) $p < 5$

183. A regular octagon has a perimeter of 88 cm. What is the length of one side?

- A) 11 cm
- B) 10 cm
- C) 12 cm
- D) 8 cm

184. A right triangle has legs measuring 9 units and 12 units. What is the length of its hypotenuse?

- A) 13 units
- B) 14 units
- C) 15 units
- D) 21 units

185. A circle has a radius of 6 cm. What is its area in terms of π ?

- A) $12\pi \text{ cm}^2$
- B) $18\pi \text{ cm}^2$
- C) $24\pi \text{ cm}^2$
- D) $36\pi \text{ cm}^2$

186. A cyclist travels 27 miles in 1.5 hours. What is the cyclist's average speed?

- A) 15 miles per hour
- B) 18 miles per hour
- C) 20 miles per hour
- D) 24 miles per hour

187. A container holds 2.4 liters. How many milliliters does it hold?

- A) 24,000
- B) 240
- C) 2,400
- D) 24

188. The numbers 12, 18, 15, 21, and x have a mean of 17. What is x ?

- A) 19
- B) 18
- C) 17
- D) 20

189. A bag contains 4 white, 5 black, and 3 gray tiles. One tile is selected at random. What is the probability that it is not black?

- A) $5/12$
- B) $1/2$
- C) $2/3$
- D) $7/12$

190. The data set 6, 9, 9, 12, 14, 14, 14, 17 is given. Which statement is true?

- A) The median is 14.
- B) The range is 9.
- C) The mean is 14.
- D) The mode is 14.

191. What is the value of $|-8| + |3 - 10|$?

- A) 15
- B) 12
- C) 5
- D) 1

192. Which fraction is equivalent to 0.375?

- A) $\frac{2}{5}$
- B) $\frac{7}{16}$
- C) $\frac{5}{12}$
- D) $\frac{3}{8}$

193. Which number is prime?

- A) 51
- B) 57
- C) 61
- D) 69

194. Solve: $7x - 5 = 3x + 19$.

- A) 4
- B) 5
- C) 6
- D) 7

195. The function rule is $f(n) = n^2 - 4$. What is $f(5)$?

- A) 21
- B) 17
- C) 25
- D) 29

196. A rectangular garden has a width of w feet and a length that is 5 feet greater than its width. Which expression represents its perimeter?

- A) $2w + 5$
- B) $4w + 10$
- C) $2w + 10$
- D) $4w + 5$

197. A tank contains 84 gallons of water and loses 6 gallons each hour. Which expression gives the number of gallons remaining after h hours?

- A) $6h - 84$
- B) $84 + 6h$
- C) $84 - 6h$
- D) $78h$

198. Two angles are supplementary. One angle measures 124° . What is the measure of the other angle?

- A) 66°
- B) 56°
- C) 46°
- D) 76°

199. A rectangular prism measures 4 cm by 5 cm by 9 cm. What is its surface area?

- A) 130 cm^2
- B) 202 cm^2
- C) 180 cm^2
- D) 162 cm^2

200. Two similar triangles have corresponding side lengths 6 cm and 15 cm. If another side of the smaller triangle is 8 cm, what is the corresponding side of the larger triangle?

- A) 17 cm
- B) 18 cm
- C) 20 cm
- D) 24 cm

201. A movie begins at 6:47 p.m. and lasts 2 hours 18 minutes. At what time does it end?

- A) 8:55 p.m.
- B) 9:25 p.m.
- C) 9:15 p.m.
- D) 9:05 p.m.

202. A board is 7 feet 6 inches long. How many inches long is the board?

- A) 96 inches
- B) 84 inches
- C) 90 inches
- D) 102 inches

203. A map uses a scale of 1 inch = 18 miles. Two towns are 3.5 inches apart on the map. What is the actual distance between them?

- A) 54 miles
- B) 58 miles
- C) 72 miles
- D) 63 miles

204. The data set is 14, 19, 23, 27, 31, 36. What is the median?

- A) 25
- B) 23
- C) 27
- D) 28

205. A spinner has 8 equal sections numbered 1 through 8. What is the probability of spinning a multiple of 3?

- A) $\frac{1}{4}$
- B) $\frac{3}{8}$
- C) $\frac{1}{2}$
- D) $\frac{5}{8}$

206. Group A has scores 8, 10, 12, 14, 16. Group B has scores 6, 11, 12, 13, 18. Which statement is true?

- A) Group B has the greater mean.
- B) The groups have the same mean and median.
- C) Group A has the greater range.
- D) Group A has the greater median.

207. What is the value of $\frac{3}{4} + \frac{5}{6}$?

- A) $1\frac{7}{12}$
- B) $1\frac{1}{2}$
- C) $1\frac{2}{3}$
- D) $1\frac{5}{12}$

208. Which expression has a value of 18?

- A) $24 \div 2 + 4$
- B) $3^2 + 3$
- C) $2 \times (7 + 2)$
- D) $5 \times 4 - 4$

209. What is $|-14| - |5 - 9|$?

- A) 10
- B) -10
- C) 18
- D) -18

210. A jar is $\frac{3}{10}$ full. After 21 marbles are added, it is $\frac{3}{5}$ full. How many marbles does the jar hold when full?

- A) 60
- B) 90
- C) 80
- D) 70

211. If $f(x) = 2x^2 - 3$, what is $f(4)$?

- A) 26
- B) 29
- C) 32
- D) 35

212. Which expression represents five less than twice a number t ?

- A) $5 - 2t$
- B) $2(t - 5)$
- C) $5t - 2$
- D) $2t - 5$

213. A taxi fare is \$4 plus \$2.50 per mile. If the fare is \$19, how many miles were traveled?

- A) 5
- B) 7
- C) 6
- D) 7.6

214. The perimeter of a rectangle is 42 cm. Its length is 3 cm more than twice its width. What is the width?

- A) 5 cm
- B) 6 cm
- C) 7 cm
- D) 8 cm

215. Two angles are supplementary. One angle measures 38° . What is the measure of the other angle?

- A) 152°
- B) 52°
- C) 128°
- D) 142°

216. A trapezoid has bases of 9 cm and 15 cm and height 6 cm. What is its area?

- A) 54 cm^2
- B) 90 cm^2
- C) 144 cm^2
- D) 72 cm^2

217. A rectangular prism measures 3 cm by 5 cm by 8 cm. What is its surface area?

- A) 94 cm^2
- B) 158 cm^2
- C) 240 cm^2
- D) 120 cm^2

218. A map scale states that 1 inch represents 18 miles. Two towns are 3.5 inches apart on the map. What is the actual distance?

- A) 54 miles
- B) 60 miles
- C) 63 miles
- D) 72 miles

219. A runner completes 2.5 kilometers in 12 minutes. At the same rate, how many kilometers will the runner complete in 30 minutes?

- A) 7.50
- B) 5.25
- C) 6.00
- D) 6.25

220. The median of 7, 11, 13, x , 20 is 13. If the values are listed in increasing order, which statement must be true?

- A) $x < 13$
- B) $x = 13$
- C) $x \geq 13$
- D) $x > 20$

221. A spinner has 8 equal sections numbered 1 through 8. What is the probability of spinning a number that is both even and greater than 3?

- A) $\frac{3}{8}$
- B) $\frac{1}{2}$
- C) $\frac{1}{4}$
- D) $\frac{5}{8}$

222. A set of six scores has a mean of 14. Five scores are 9, 12, 13, 16, and 18. What is the sixth score?

- A) 14
- B) 16
- C) 15
- D) 17

223. Which number is greatest?

- A) 61%
- B) 0.62
- C) $\frac{5}{8}$
- D) 0.605

224. What is the least common multiple of 12 and 18?

- A) 24
- B) 30
- C) 36
- D) 72

225. Which expression is equal to $2\frac{1}{4}$?

- A) 2.04
- B) 2.25
- C) 2.40
- D) 2.50

226. If $4a + 3b = 29$ and $a = 5$, what is b ?

- A) 3
- B) 4
- C) 5
- D) 2

227. Which inequality is equivalent to $3x + 7 < 22$?

- A) $x > 5$
- B) $x < 5$
- C) $x < 29/3$
- D) $x > 29/3$

228. A machine produces 18 parts in 6 minutes at a constant rate. Which expression gives the number of parts p produced in m minutes?

- A) $p = m + 12$
- B) $p = 3m$
- C) $p = 6m$
- D) $p = 18m$

229. The first three values in a linear relationship are (1, 7), (2, 11), and (3, 15). Which rule describes the relationship?

- A) $y = 4x + 3$
- B) $y = 3x + 4$
- C) $y = 4x + 7$
- D) $y = 7x - 3$

230. A right triangle has legs of 9 cm and 12 cm. What is the length of its hypotenuse?

- A) 13 cm
- B) 15 cm
- C) 21 cm
- D) 18 cm

231. A circle has radius 6 cm. Using 3.14 for π , what is its area?

- A) 37.68 cm^2
- B) 75.36 cm^2
- C) 113.04 cm^2
- D) 226.08 cm^2

232. Two similar triangles have corresponding side lengths 6 cm and 9 cm. If another side of the smaller triangle is 10 cm, what is the corresponding side of the larger triangle?

- A) 12 cm
- B) 13.5 cm
- C) 15 cm
- D) 16 cm

233. A container holds 3 quarts. How many cups does it hold?

- A) 16
- B) 6
- C) 8
- D) 12

234. A movie begins at 6:38 P.M. and ends at 9:12 P.M. How long is the movie?

- A) 2 hours 24 minutes
- B) 2 hours 34 minutes
- C) 2 hours 44 minutes
- D) 3 hours 34 minutes

235. A 7.5-foot board is cut into pieces that are each 18 inches long. How many complete pieces can be cut?

- A) 4
- B) 6
- C) 7
- D) 5

236. A bag contains 4 red, 3 blue, and 5 green tiles. One tile is chosen at random, replaced, and then another tile is chosen. What is the probability that both tiles are blue?

- A) $\frac{1}{16}$
- B) $\frac{1}{9}$
- C) $\frac{1}{8}$
- D) $\frac{1}{12}$

237. The data set is 6, 8, 8, 11, 14, 17. If 20 is added to the set, which measure must increase?

- A) range only
- B) mode only
- C) median only
- D) both median and range

238. In a survey, 18 students chose music, 12 chose art, 15 chose sports, and 5 chose drama. What percent of the 50 students chose sports?

- A) 25%
- B) 30%
- C) 35%
- D) 40%

Section 5: Language

60 questions | Recommended time: 30 minutes

239. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A) After checking, the weather Tessa packed a light jacket.
- B) After checking the weather Tessa, packed a light jacket.
- C) After checking the weather, Tessa packed a light jacket.
- D) After checking the weather Tessa packed, a light jacket.

240. Which sentence uses the apostrophe correctly?

- A) The two pilots checked the planes engine.
- B) The two pilot's checked the plane's engine.
- C) The two pilots checked the plane's engine.
- D) The two pilots' checked the planes' engine.

241. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A) The recipe requires: flour, yeast, water, and salt.
- B) The recipe requires flour: yeast, water, and salt.
- C) The recipe: requires flour, yeast, water, and salt.
- D) The recipe requires four ingredients: flour, yeast, water, and salt.

242. Which sentence uses capitalization correctly?

- A) Our class studied the Pacific Ocean during science.
- B) Our class studied the Pacific ocean during Science.
- C) Our Class studied the Pacific Ocean during science.
- D) Our class studied the pacific Ocean during Science.

243. Which sentence uses capitalization correctly?

- A) In October, Dr. Ramos will speak at the National History Center.
- B) In October, dr. Ramos will speak at the National History Center.
- C) In october, Dr. Ramos will speak at the National History Center.
- D) In October, Dr. Ramos will speak at the national History Center.

244. Which word is spelled correctly?

- A) maintanance
- B) maintainance
- C) maintenence
- D) maintenance

245. Which sentence contains a misspelled word?

- A) The committee reached a decision after lunch.
- B) We received the package before noon.
- C) Her explanation was completely independant of mine.
- D) The architect revised the original sketch.

246. Which sentence is grammatically correct?

- A) Neither of the lanterns is bright enough.
- B) Neither of the lanterns have been repaired.
- C) Neither of the lanterns were bright enough.
- D) Neither of the lanterns shine brightly enough.

247. Which sentence uses pronouns correctly?

- A) The coach gave the instructions to Maya and I.
- B) The coach gave Maya and myself the instructions.
- C) The coach gave the instructions to Maya and me.
- D) The coach gave the instructions to she and Maya.

248. Which sentence has correct parallel structure?

- A) The internship requires arriving on time, to follow directions, and daily records.
- B) The internship requires arriving on time, following directions, and completing daily records.
- C) The internship requires punctual arrival, following directions, and to complete daily records.
- D) The internship requires to arrive on time, directions should be followed, and completing records.

249. Which sentence uses the most precise word?

- A) The technician did the loose wire before testing the circuit.
- B) The technician secured the loose wire before testing the circuit.
- C) The technician got the loose wire before testing the circuit.
- D) The technician made the loose wire before testing the circuit.

250. Which sentence is most concise without changing the meaning?

- A) The outcome surprised everyone.
- B) The outcome that was final surprised everyone in attendance there.
- C) The final outcome at the end surprised everyone.
- D) The final outcome surprised each and every person.

Editing Passage: Restoring a Mechanical Clock

(1) A mechanical clock can continue working for generations when its parts are properly maintained. (2) During restoration, a craftsperson first examines the mechanism and records where each component belongs. (3) Tiny gears, springs, and screws are then removed and cleaned carefully. (4) Some old clocks have decorative cases made from wood or metal. (5) Damaged components may need repair, but replacing an original part is not always the first choice. (6) After the mechanism is reassembled, the restorer observes the clock over time to check its accuracy. (7) This patient process protects both the clock's function and much of its original workmanship.

251. Which sentence should be removed because it is least relevant to the paragraph's focus on the restoration process?

- A) Sentence 4
- B) Sentence 2
- C) Sentence 6
- D) Sentence 7

252. Which sentence would be the best topic sentence for this passage?

- A) Clocks are available in many sizes and styles.
- B) Some people collect objects from earlier centuries.
- C) Restoring a mechanical clock requires careful attention to both its operation and original parts.
- D) Mechanical devices often contain small metal parts.

253. Where would the following sentence fit best? "Before any part is moved, however, the restorer must understand how the mechanism is arranged."

- A) Before sentence 1
- B) After sentence 7
- C) Between sentences 5 and 6
- D) Between sentences 1 and 2

254. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A) The storm ended; however, the roads remained flooded.
- B) The storm ended, however the roads remained flooded.
- C) The storm ended however; the roads remained flooded.
- D) The storm ended, however; the roads remained flooded.

255. Which sentence uses quotation marks and punctuation correctly?

- A) "Please close the window", Mr. Vega said.
- B) "Please close the window," Mr. Vega said.
- C) "Please close the window" Mr. Vega said.
- D) "Please close the window", Mr. Vega said

256. Which sentence uses capitalization correctly?

- A) We traveled South on River Road before turning onto oak avenue.
- B) We traveled South on river road before turning onto Oak avenue.
- C) We traveled south on River road before turning onto oak Avenue.
- D) We traveled south on River Road before turning onto Oak Avenue.

257. Which sentence uses capitalization correctly?

- A) My cousin speaks Spanish and is learning french.
- B) My cousin speaks Spanish and is learning French.
- C) My Cousin speaks Spanish and is learning French.
- D) My cousin speaks spanish and is learning French.

258. Which word is spelled correctly?

- A) occasion
- B) occassion
- C) ocasion
- D) occaision

259. Which sentence contains a misspelled word?

- A) The hikers followed a narrow trail.
- B) The machine required frequent lubrification.
- C) The manager guaranteed delivery by Friday.
- D) The musician adjusted the microphone.

260. Which sentence contains no spelling errors?

- A) The laboratory purchased new equiptment.
- B) The guide reccomended an alternate route.
- C) The audience applauded the performance enthusiastically.
- D) The carpenter measured the dimentions carefully.

261. Which sentence uses verb tense correctly?

- A) By the time we arrived, the train had already left.
- B) By the time we arrived, the train has already left.
- C) By the time we arrived, the train already leaves.
- D) By the time we arrived, the train already leaving.

262. Which sentence is complete and correctly constructed?

- A) Because the road was closed for repairs, the bus followed a detour.
- B) While waiting near the entrance for the doors to open.
- C) Although the forecast predicted rain throughout the afternoon.
- D) Because the road was closed for repairs.

263. Which sentence places the modifying phrase correctly?

- A) Covered in frost, Lena photographed the branches.
- B) Covered in frost, the branches were photographed by Lena near the path.
- C) Lena photographed the branches covered in frost.
- D) While covered in frost, Lena photographed the branches.

264. Which sentence uses the correct word?

- A) The new schedule will effect when the buses depart.
- B) The new schedule will affect when the buses depart.
- C) The new schedule will effecting when the buses depart.
- D) The new schedule will affected when the buses depart.

265. Which sentence uses the clearest pronoun reference?

- A) When Marcus spoke to Daniel, he sounded worried.
- B) After the jar struck the bowl, it cracked.
- C) Elena had been helpful, so Priya thanked her.
- D) Priya thanked Elena because she had been helpful.

Editing Passage: A Small Observatory

(1) The astronomy club wanted a permanent place to observe the night sky. (2) Members first identified a level area behind the science building where nearby lights caused little glare. (3) They then built a simple platform large enough for two telescopes and several observers. (4) The club meets every Wednesday after school in Room 18. (5) A low railing was added for safety without blocking the view of the horizon. (6) Finally, students created a schedule so different groups could use the platform during evening observation sessions. (7) The finished space gave the club a safer and more organized way to conduct its observations.

266. Which sentence should be removed to improve the unity of the passage?

- A) Sentence 7
- B) Sentence 2
- C) Sentence 5
- D) Sentence 4

267. Which transition would best begin sentence 5?

- A) Next,
- B) For example,
- C) In contrast,
- D) Nevertheless,

268. Which revision best combines sentences 6 and 7 while preserving their meaning?

- A) Finally, students created a schedule, and the club had observations.
- B) Finally, students created a schedule for evening use, helping make the finished platform safer and more organized.
- C) The club created a safer place because students made a schedule every evening.
- D) Different groups used the platform, which was finished and safer.

269. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A) The storm ended, however; the roads remained flooded.
- B) The storm ended; however, the roads remained flooded.
- C) The storm ended however, the roads remained flooded.
- D) The storm ended: however the roads remained flooded.

270. Which sentence uses quotation marks and punctuation correctly?

- A) "Please label each sample", said Dr. Chen.
- B) "Please label each sample" said, Dr. Chen.
- C) "Please label each sample," said Dr. Chen.
- D) Please "label each sample," said Dr. Chen.

271. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A) The hikers carried three essentials; water, maps, and flashlights.
- B) The hikers carried three essentials, water; maps; and flashlights.
- C) The hikers carried three essentials: water, maps, and flashlights.
- D) The hikers: carried three essentials, water, maps, and flashlights.

272. Which sentence uses capitalization correctly?

- A) My cousin studies french and Algebra at Lincoln Middle School.
- B) My cousin studies French and algebra at Lincoln Middle School.
- C) My cousin studies French and Algebra at lincoln Middle School.
- D) My Cousin studies French and algebra at Lincoln middle school.

273. Which sentence uses capitalization correctly?

- A) On memorial Day, we visited aunt Rosa in the West.
- B) On Memorial Day, we visited Aunt Rosa in the West.
- C) On Memorial day, we visited Aunt Rosa in the west.
- D) On memorial day, we visited Aunt rosa in the West.

274. Which word is spelled correctly?

- A) occurence
- B) occurrence
- C) occurance
- D) occurrence

275. Which sentence contains a misspelled word?

- A) The audience applauded enthusiastically.
- B) The schedule was adjusted for convenience.
- C) The witness gave a consistant account.
- D) The mechanic identified a separate problem.

276. Which sentence is grammatically correct?

- A) Each of the volunteers bring a reusable bottle.
- B) Each of the volunteers have brought a reusable bottle.
- C) Each of the volunteers were bringing a reusable bottle.
- D) Each of the volunteers brings a reusable bottle.

277. Which sentence places the modifier correctly?

- A) Covered in frost, Lena photographed the window.
- B) Lena photographed the window covered in frost.
- C) Lena photographed, covered in frost, the window.
- D) Covered in frost, the photograph was taken by Lena.

278. Which sentence uses verb tense correctly?

- A) By the time the bus arrived, Marco waits for twenty minutes.
- B) By the time the bus arrived, Marco had waited for twenty minutes.
- C) By the time the bus arrived, Marco has waited for twenty minutes.
- D) By the time the bus arrives, Marco had waited for twenty minutes.

279. Which sentence uses the correct word?

- A) The new policy may effect how supplies are ordered.
- B) The new policy may except how supplies are ordered.
- C) The new policy may accept how supplies are ordered.
- D) The new policy may affect how supplies are ordered.

280. Which sentence has the clearest pronoun reference?

- A) When Ava spoke to Priya, she was carrying the model.
- B) When Ava spoke to Priya, it was being carried.
- C) Ava spoke to Priya while carrying the model.
- D) She spoke to Priya while Ava carried the model.

281. Which transition best completes the sentence? The first prototype was lightweight. ____, it could not withstand repeated impacts.

- A) Therefore
- B) For example
- C) Similarly
- D) However

Editing Passage: Recording Urban Heat

(1) On summer afternoons, paved areas can become much warmer than nearby shaded ground. (2) A student science group decided to compare temperatures at several locations around its neighborhood. (3) The students measured the same locations at the same times for five days. (4) They also recorded whether each location was shaded and what material covered the ground. (5) One student owned a bicycle with a bright orange frame. (6) By keeping the schedule and method consistent, the group could compare its observations more fairly. (7) The results did not explain every cause of temperature differences, but they revealed patterns worth investigating further.

282. Which sentence should be removed because it does not support the paragraph's focus?

- A) Sentence 2
- B) Sentence 7
- C) Sentence 4
- D) Sentence 5

283. Which revision best combines sentences 3 and 4?

- A) For five days, the students measured the same locations at the same times and recorded each site's shade conditions and ground material.
- B) Recording shade, the ground material measured the same locations for five days.
- C) The students measured locations, and for five days the same times were shade and material.
- D) The students measured for five days; because shade and ground material were locations.

284. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A) Before leaving the laboratory Maya checked every cabinet.
- B) Before leaving, the laboratory Maya checked every cabinet.
- C) Before, leaving the laboratory Maya checked every cabinet.
- D) Before leaving the laboratory, Maya checked every cabinet.

285. Which sentence uses the apostrophe correctly?

- A) The two players uniforms were hanging in the locker room.
- B) The two player's uniforms were hanging in the locker room.
- C) The two players' uniforms were hanging in the locker room.
- D) The two players's uniforms were hanging in the locker room.

286. Which sentence uses capitalization correctly?

- A) Professor Lin will speak at the National Science Museum on Tuesday.
- B) professor Lin will speak at the National science museum on Tuesday.
- C) Professor Lin will speak at the national Science Museum on tuesday.
- D) Professor lin will speak at the National Science museum on Tuesday.

287. Which sentence uses capitalization correctly?

- A) We crossed the Mississippi River before entering arkansas.
- B) We crossed the Mississippi River before entering Arkansas.
- C) We crossed the Mississippi river before entering Arkansas.
- D) We crossed the mississippi river before entering Arkansas.

288. Which word is spelled correctly?

- A) occasionally
- B) occassionally
- C) ocasionaly
- D) occasionly

289. Which sentence contains a misspelled word?

- A) The instructions were completely neccessary.
- B) The athlete followed a rigorous training schedule.
- C) The committee reached a unanimous decision.
- D) The museum displayed an ancient artifact.

290. Which sentence contains no spelling errors?

- A) The engineer checked the guage before starting the test.
- B) The hikers carried seperate containers for water.
- C) The speaker recieved several questions afterward.
- D) The principal announced a temporary schedule change.

291. Which sentence uses the pronoun correctly?

- A) The coach gave the certificates to Jordan and I.
- B) The coach gave Jordan and myself the certificates.
- C) The coach gave the certificates to Jordan and me.
- D) The coach gave the certificates to me and he.

292. Which sentence has correct parallel structure?

- A) The job requires measuring parts, recording results, and to clean equipment.
- B) The job requires measurement of parts, recording results, and equipment cleaning.
- C) The job requires to measure parts, results are recorded, and cleaning equipment.
- D) The job requires measuring parts, recording results, and cleaning equipment.

293. Which is a complete sentence?

- A) Because the rain continued throughout the afternoon.
- B) The team postponed practice until the field dried.
- C) After the buses had already departed.
- D) While waiting for the final announcement.

294. Which sentence uses the correct word?

- A) Less volunteers arrived after the storm.
- B) The storm had less effects than forecasters expected.
- C) Fewer equipment was damaged than expected.
- D) Fewer trees were damaged than expected.

295. Which sentence is most concise?

- A) The reason the meeting was delayed was because the manager arrived late.
- B) The meeting was delayed because the manager arrived late.
- C) The meeting was delayed due to the fact that the manager arrived late.
- D) Because the manager arrived late, this was the reason for the meeting's delay.

296. Which transition best completes the sentence? The trail was steep and rocky. _____, the experienced hikers reached the summit before noon.

- A) Therefore
- B) For instance
- C) Likewise
- D) Nevertheless

Editing Passage: A Better Lunchroom System

(1) At Jefferson Middle School, students once formed one long line to buy lunch. (2) The line often stretched across the cafeteria, making it difficult for students to reach tables. (3) The school tested a new system with two serving stations offering the same main choices. (4) During the first week, staff members recorded how long students waited at each station. (5) Average waiting time fell, although one station became crowded whenever students entered through the nearest door. (6) Staff members then placed a sign directing some students toward the second station. (7) The adjustment did not eliminate every delay. (8) It showed that observing how people actually use a system can reveal simple ways to improve it.

297. Where would the following sentence best be placed? “The goal was to shorten waiting time without changing the menu.”

- A) After sentence 2
- B) After sentence 5
- C) Before sentence 1
- D) After sentence 8

298. Which revision of sentence 7 best strengthens the conclusion?

- A) The adjustment was an adjustment that changed some things about delays.
- B) Delays existed, and the cafeteria had tables and serving stations.
- C) The adjustment did not eliminate every delay, but it reduced the crowding that the staff had observed.
- D) Every delay disappeared immediately after the sign was placed.

Answer Key

Question numbers continue across all five sections.

Verbal Skills

1. D	2. A	3. A	4. C	5. C	6. D	7. D	8. A
9. A	10. B	11. D	12. B	13. A	14. D	15. C	16. B
17. D	18. C	19. B	20. B	21. A	22. C	23. A	24. B
25. C	26. A	27. C	28. A	29. C	30. B	31. A	32. D
33. C	34. B	35. D	36. D	37. C	38. A	39. D	40. C
41. B	42. C	43. D	44. B	45. D	46. A	47. C	48. B
49. C	50. D	51. B	52. C	53. A	54. D	55. B	56. A
57. A	58. D	59. B	60. B				

Quantitative Skills

61. D	62. C	63. B	64. C	65. D	66. C	67. B	68. B
69. D	70. A	71. C	72. B	73. A	74. A	75. C	76. A
77. D	78. B	79. A	80. C	81. A	82. A	83. B	84. D
85. A	86. D	87. B	88. B	89. D	90. A	91. C	92. D
93. D	94. B	95. C	96. A	97. B	98. A	99. C	100. C
101. D	102. B	103. C	104. C	105. A	106. D	107. D	108. A
109. D	110. B	111. B	112. C				

Reading Comprehension

113. A	114. C	115. C	116. A	117. D	118. B	119. D	120. A
121. B	122. A	123. A	124. B	125. D	126. C	127. C	128. A
129. D	130. A	131. A	132. D	133. C	134. C	135. D	136. B
137. B	138. C	139. D	140. A	141. B	142. B	143. C	144. A
145. D	146. A	147. D	148. C	149. B	150. A	151. C	152. D
153. B	154. A	155. A	156. C	157. B	158. D	159. B	160. C
161. D	162. A	163. B	164. C	165. B	166. D	167. B	168. B
169. D	170. C	171. A	172. B	173. C	174. D		

Mathematics

175. A	176. A	177. D	178. C	179. D	180. A	181. B	182. A
183. A	184. C	185. D	186. B	187. C	188. A	189. D	190. D
191. A	192. D	193. C	194. C	195. A	196. B	197. C	198. B
199. B	200. C	201. D	202. C	203. D	204. A	205. A	206. B

207. A	208. C	209. A	210. D	211. B	212. D	213. C	214. B
215. D	216. D	217. B	218. C	219. D	220. C	221. A	222. B
223. C	224. C	225. B	226. A	227. B	228. B	229. A	230. B
231. C	232. C	233. D	234. B	235. D	236. A	237. D	238. B

Language

239. C	240. C	241. D	242. A	243. A	244. D	245. C	246. A
247. C	248. B	249. B	250. A	251. A	252. C	253. D	254. A
255. B	256. D	257. B	258. A	259. B	260. C	261. A	262. A
263. C	264. B	265. C	266. D	267. A	268. B	269. B	270. C
271. C	272. B	273. B	274. D	275. C	276. D	277. B	278. B
279. D	280. C	281. D	282. D	283. A	284. D	285. C	286. A
287. B	288. A	289. A	290. D	291. C	292. D	293. B	294. D
295. B	296. D	297. A	298. C				

Detailed Explanations

Verbal Skills

1. HSPT-V6-001 - Answer D: inactive

Dormant describes something temporarily inactive or not currently developing or functioning.

2. HSPT-V6-002 - Answer A: examine

To scrutinize something means to examine it closely and carefully.

3. HSPT-V6-003 - Answer A: adaptable

Versatile describes someone or something able to perform effectively in varied roles or situations.

4. HSPT-V6-004 - Answer C: reduce

Amplify means to increase or strengthen something, so reduce expresses the opposite idea.

5. HSPT-V6-005 - Answer C: fertile

Barren land produces little or no vegetation, whereas fertile land supports productive growth.

6. HSPT-V6-006 - Answer D: continuous

Sporadic means occurring irregularly or occasionally, while continuous means occurring without interruption.

7. HSPT-V6-007 - Answer D: horse

A sapling is a young tree, just as a foal is a young horse.

8. HSPT-V6-008 - Answer A: vapor

Friction can produce heat, while evaporation produces vapor from liquid.

9. HSPT-V6-009 - Answer A: knife

A scabbard holds and protects a sword, while a sheath commonly holds and protects a knife.

10. HSPT-V6-010 - Answer B: paragraph

Sonnet, haiku, and limerick are poetic forms, while a paragraph is not.

11. HSPT-V6-011 - Answer D: pine

Cedar, spruce, fir, and pine are all commonly classified as coniferous trees.

12. HSPT-V6-012 - Answer B: rainfall

Altitude, latitude, and longitude describe positional or geographic measurements, while rainfall measures precipitation.

13. HSPT-V6-013 - Answer A: No bronze token is blank.

Every bronze token is numbered, and no numbered object is blank, so no bronze token can be blank.

14. HSPT-V6-014 - Answer D: K

K must be above M, which is above J, which is above L, placing K at the top.

15. HSPT-V6-015 - Answer C: Lina attends ceramics Tuesday.

Ceramics occurs only Tuesday or Thursday, and Lina cannot attend Thursday, so attendance requires Tuesday.

16. HSPT-V6-016 - Answer B: believable

Plausible describes something that seems reasonable or believable.

17. HSPT-V6-017 - Answer D: obstruct

To hinder something means to delay, interfere with, or obstruct its progress.

18. HSPT-V6-018 - Answer C: outdated

Obsolete describes something no longer current or useful because it has been replaced or superseded.

19. HSPT-V6-019 - Answer B: reckless

Cautious means careful about possible danger, while reckless describes acting without appropriate caution.

20. HSPT-V6-020 - Answer B: abundant

Scarce means limited or insufficient in amount, whereas abundant means plentiful.

21. HSPT-V6-021 - Answer A: simple

Intricate means very detailed or complicated, while simple means uncomplicated.

22. HSPT-V6-022 - Answer C: building

A composer creates a symphony, just as an architect designs a building.

23. HSPT-V6-023 - Answer A: rest

Food responds to hunger, just as rest responds to fatigue.

24. HSPT-V6-024 - Answer B: symphony
A chapter is a major division of a novel, while a movement is a major division of a symphony.
25. HSPT-V6-025 - Answer C: limestone
Copper, iron, and silver are metals, whereas limestone is a rock.
26. HSPT-V6-026 - Answer A: magnifying glass
All four devices magnify or improve visual observation of objects.
27. HSPT-V6-027 - Answer C: shout
Whisper, murmur, and mutter describe quiet speech, while shout describes loud speech.
28. HSPT-V6-028 - Answer A: The package is not fragile.
Fragile packages always receive red labels, so the absence of a red label rules out fragility.
29. HSPT-V6-029 - Answer C: R
S cannot be first, and T cannot precede R, so R must occupy the first position.
30. HSPT-V6-030 - Answer B: Every orchid has a tag.
The first statement directly establishes that every orchid in the greenhouse is tagged.
31. HSPT-V6-031 - Answer A: thorough
Meticulous means extremely careful and attentive to details.
32. HSPT-V6-032 - Answer D: able to recover
Resilient describes something able to recover or return to form after difficulty or strain.
33. HSPT-V6-033 - Answer C: surrender
To relinquish something is to give it up or surrender it.
34. HSPT-V6-034 - Answer B: flexible
Rigid means stiff or inflexible, so flexible is its clearest opposite.
35. HSPT-V6-035 - Answer D: abundant
Scarce means limited or insufficient, while abundant means plentiful.
36. HSPT-V6-036 - Answer D: opaque
Transparent material allows light through clearly; opaque material does not.
37. HSPT-V6-037 - Answer C: temperature
A compass indicates direction, while a thermometer indicates temperature.
38. HSPT-V6-038 - Answer A: pottery
Wool is a material used to make a sweater; clay is a material used to make pottery.
39. HSPT-V6-039 - Answer D: ship
An orchestra is a group of musicians; a fleet is a group of ships.
40. HSPT-V6-040 - Answer C: plateau
Bay, cove, and inlet describe bodies or arms of water; a plateau is an elevated landform.
41. HSPT-V6-041 - Answer B: heater
A kiln, furnace, oven, and heater are devices that produce or apply heat.
42. HSPT-V6-042 - Answer C: telescope
Prologue, chapter, and epilogue are parts of written works; telescope is an optical instrument.
43. HSPT-V6-043 - Answer D: Every amber box is sealed.
The first statement directly establishes that every amber box belongs to the group of sealed boxes.
44. HSPT-V6-044 - Answer B: N
N must occur after K, so N cannot occupy the first position.
45. HSPT-V6-045 - Answer D: blue, wood, round or square
Not glass forces wood; the shape remains either round or square, while blue is already specified.
46. HSPT-V6-046 - Answer A: cautious
Prudent means showing careful judgment, so cautious is the closest synonym.
47. HSPT-V6-047 - Answer C: brief
Concise means expressing something in few words without unnecessary detail.
48. HSPT-V6-048 - Answer B: delay
To hinder is to obstruct, slow, or delay progress.
49. HSPT-V6-049 - Answer C: occupied
Vacant means empty or unoccupied, making occupied its clearest opposite.

50. HSPT-V6-050 - Answer D: natural

Artificial means made rather than naturally occurring, so natural is the opposite.

51. HSPT-V6-051 - Answer B: increase

Diminish means to become or make smaller, while increase means to become greater.

52. HSPT-V6-052 - Answer C: scissors

A mason uses a trowel as a work tool; a barber uses scissors as a work tool.

53. HSPT-V6-053 - Answer A: butterfly

A bud develops into a flower, just as a caterpillar develops into a butterfly.

54. HSPT-V6-054 - Answer D: grain

A reservoir stores water; a silo commonly stores grain.

55. HSPT-V6-055 - Answer B: tulip

Elm, cedar, and maple are trees, while a tulip is a flowering plant that is not a tree.

56. HSPT-V6-056 - Answer A: payment record

Invoices, receipts, bills, and payment records are documents associated with transactions and amounts owed or paid.

57. HSPT-V6-057 - Answer A: shout

Whisper, murmur, and mutter describe quiet speech, while shout describes loud speech.

58. HSPT-V6-058 - Answer D: P, S, Q, R

This order places P before R and keeps S immediately before Q, satisfying both constraints.

59. HSPT-V6-059 - Answer B: The library is not open.

If opening requires the lights to be on, lights being off means the library cannot be open.

60. HSPT-V6-060 - Answer B: green

White and orange must form the middle-right pair, forcing purple left of green and green into the final position.

Quantitative Skills

61. HSPT-Q6-001 - Answer D: 158

Each term is doubled and then 2 is added: $3 \times 2 + 2 = 8$, continuing to $78 \times 2 + 2 = 158$.

62. HSPT-Q6-002 - Answer C: 55

The differences are -9, -8, -7, and -6, so the next difference is -5: $60 - 5 = 55$.

63. HSPT-Q6-003 - Answer B: 40

The sequence alternates $\times 2 + 1$ and -1 .

64. HSPT-Q6-004 - Answer C: $1 \frac{1}{2}$

Each term increases by $\frac{1}{4}$, so $1 \frac{1}{4} + \frac{1}{4} = 1 \frac{1}{2}$.

65. HSPT-Q6-005 - Answer D: 12

If $3x - 7 = 29$, then $3x = 36$ and $x = 12$.

66. HSPT-Q6-006 - Answer C: 28

35% of 80 is $0.35 \times 80 = 28$.

67. HSPT-Q6-007 - Answer B: 3.5

Dividing the total equally gives $17.5 \div 5 = 3.5$ liters per container.

68. HSPT-Q6-008 - Answer B: Quantity B is greater.

Quantity A is 30, while Quantity B is 32, so Quantity B is greater.

69. HSPT-Q6-009 - Answer D: Quantity B is greater.

The greatest common factor is 6, while the least prime greater than 5 is 7.

70. HSPT-Q6-010 - Answer A: The two quantities are equal.

Solving $3x + 6 = 42$ gives $x = 12$, equal to Quantity B.

71. HSPT-Q6-011 - Answer C: Quantity A is greater.

The square's area is 49 cm^2 and the rectangle's area is 48 cm^2 .

72. HSPT-Q6-012 - Answer B: Quantity B is greater.

The triangle perimeter is 27 cm, while the circle circumference is approximately 28.26 cm.

73. HSPT-Q6-013 - Answer A: The two quantities are equal.

A triangle totals 180° , so the third angle is $180 - 47 - 68 = 65^\circ$.

74. HSPT-Q6-014 - Answer A: 49

The increases are 3, 6, 9, and 12; the next increase is 15, giving $34 + 15 = 49$.

75. HSPT-Q6-015 - Answer C: 6

Each term is one-half the previous term, so $12 \div 2 = 6$.

76. HSPT-Q6-016 - Answer A: 14

The sequence alternates $+4$ and -1 , so after 15 the next term is 14.

77. HSPT-Q6-017 - Answer D: 42

Dividing 42 by 5 gives 8 remainder 2.

78. HSPT-Q6-018 - Answer B: 15

If 5 ratio parts equal 25 beads, each part equals 5; therefore 3 parts equal 15.

79. HSPT-Q6-019 - Answer A: $6 \times 14 - 6 \times 9$

The distributive property gives $6(14 - 9) = 6 \times 14 - 6 \times 9$.

80. HSPT-Q6-020 - Answer C: 45

If the original value is x , then $1.2x = 54$, so $x = 45$.

81. HSPT-Q6-021 - Answer A: Quantity A is greater.

Quantity A equals 42, while Quantity B equals $49 - 8 = 41$.

82. HSPT-Q6-022 - Answer A: The two quantities are equal.

$|-14| = 14$ and $\sqrt{196} = 14$.

83. HSPT-Q6-023 - Answer B: The relationship cannot be determined from the information given.

n could be 7, 8, 9, 10, or 11, so it may be less than, equal to, or greater than 9.

84. HSPT-Q6-024 - Answer D: Quantity B is greater.

The prism's volume is $2 \times 3 \times 8 = 48 \text{ cm}^3$, which is less than 50 cm^3 .

85. HSPT-Q6-025 - Answer A: Quantity A is greater.
A circle's diameter is twice its radius, so the diameter is 22 cm, greater than 20 cm.
86. HSPT-Q6-026 - Answer D: The two quantities are equal.
The triangle area is $\frac{1}{2} \times 12 \times 7 = 42 \text{ cm}^2$, and the parallelogram area is $7 \times 6 = 42 \text{ cm}^2$.
87. HSPT-Q6-027 - Answer B: 49
The increases are 3, 6, 9, and 12; the next increase is 15, giving 49.
88. HSPT-Q6-028 - Answer B: 74
The operations alternate adding 3 and multiplying by 2; $37 \times 2 = 74$.
89. HSPT-Q6-029 - Answer D: 123
The operations alternate $\times 3$ and -1 , so $41 \times 3 = 123$.
90. HSPT-Q6-030 - Answer A: 46
The increases are 3, 6, 9, and 12; adding the next increase, 15, gives 46.
91. HSPT-Q6-031 - Answer C: 72
If 125% of the original is 90, then the original is $90 \div 1.25 = 72$.
92. HSPT-Q6-032 - Answer D: $\frac{3}{8}$
 $0.375 = \frac{375}{1000}$, which simplifies to $\frac{3}{8}$.
93. HSPT-Q6-033 - Answer D: 16
Multiplying 7 by 4 gives 28, so the matching blue quantity is $4 \times 4 = 16$.
94. HSPT-Q6-034 - Answer B: Quantity A is greater.
Quantity A is 42; Quantity B is 41, so Quantity A is greater.
95. HSPT-Q6-035 - Answer C: Quantity B is greater.
Solving gives $n = 9$, so Quantity B, 10, is greater.
96. HSPT-Q6-036 - Answer A: The two quantities are equal.
The positive factors of 18 are 1, 2, 3, 6, 9, and 18, exactly six factors.
97. HSPT-Q6-037 - Answer B: Quantity A is greater.
The triangle's area is $\frac{1}{2} \times 12 \times 7 = 42 \text{ cm}^2$, which is greater than 40 cm^2 .
98. HSPT-Q6-038 - Answer A: The two quantities are equal.
The cube's volume is $4^3 = 64 \text{ cm}^3$, equal to Quantity B.
99. HSPT-Q6-039 - Answer C: The two quantities are equal.
The rectangle perimeter is $2(11 + 5) = 32 \text{ cm}$, and the square perimeter is $4 \times 8 = 32 \text{ cm}$.
100. HSPT-Q6-040 - Answer C: 162
Each term is multiplied by 3, so $54 \times 3 = 162$.
101. HSPT-Q6-041 - Answer D: 46
The amounts subtracted decrease by 1: 9, 8, 7, 6, then 5; $51 - 5 = 46$.
102. HSPT-Q6-042 - Answer B: 38
The operations alternate $+1$ and $\times 2$; after 19, multiply by 2 to get 38.
103. HSPT-Q6-043 - Answer C: \$68
Fifteen percent of \$80 is \$12, and $\$80 - \$12 = \$68$.
104. HSPT-Q6-044 - Answer C: 54
A number divisible by both 6 and 9 must be divisible by 18; 54 satisfies both conditions.
105. HSPT-Q6-045 - Answer A: \$22.00
Each notebook costs $\$13.75 \div 5 = \2.75 ; eight cost $8 \times \$2.75 = \22.00 .
106. HSPT-Q6-046 - Answer D: 36
If $n \div 4 + 7 = 16$, then $n \div 4 = 9$ and $n = 36$.
107. HSPT-Q6-047 - Answer D: Quantity A is greater.
Quantity A is $0.35 \times 80 = 28$; Quantity B is $0.30 \times 90 = 27$.
108. HSPT-Q6-048 - Answer A: Quantity A is greater.
Solving $3x - 4 = 20$ gives $x = 8$, which is greater than 7.
109. HSPT-Q6-049 - Answer D: Quantity A is greater.
 $47 \div 6$ leaves remainder 5, while $38 \div 5$ leaves remainder 3, so Quantity A is greater.
110. HSPT-Q6-050 - Answer B: The two quantities are equal.
A diameter of 10 cm means a radius of 5 cm, so both circles have the same circumference.

111. HSPT-Q6-051 - Answer B: Quantity B is greater.

The square has side 7 cm and area 49 cm^2 , so 50 cm^2 is greater.

112. HSPT-Q6-052 - Answer C: The two quantities are equal.

The third angle is $180^\circ - 48^\circ - 67^\circ = 65^\circ$, equal to Quantity B.

Reading Comprehension

113. HSPT-R6-001 - Answer A: Her bell is wrapped tightly in cloth.

The passage explicitly states that Mara's bell is wrapped tightly, allowing her to rule it out as the source.

114. HSPT-R6-002 - Answer C: The pilot is taking precautions because visibility is limited.

The pilot moves slowly and rings a bell to warn other vessels in the fog.

115. HSPT-R6-003 - Answer C: difficult to hear.

The ringing is initially weak and distant, so faint means difficult to hear.

116. HSPT-R6-004 - Answer A: reveal how an ordinary object gains new meaning for her.

Mara shifts from viewing bells as announcements to understanding their important safety function.

117. HSPT-R6-005 - Answer D: Familiar things can take on greater meaning when their purpose is understood.

Mara's experience changes her understanding of a familiar bell by revealing another important purpose.

118. HSPT-R6-006 - Answer B: It protects finer material beneath it from wind erosion.

The passage directly states that the stone layer shields finer underlying material from wind erosion.

119. HSPT-R6-007 - Answer D: Repeated swelling and shrinking of soil

The passage identifies repeated soil expansion and contraction as one process that gradually raises stones.

120. HSPT-R6-008 - Answer A: keep over time.

In context, preserve means that an undisturbed surface can retain evidence for long periods.

121. HSPT-R6-009 - Answer B: It describes a feature, explains processes that form it, and discusses why it is useful to researchers.

The passage moves from description to formation processes and finally to the scientific value of desert pavement.

122. HSPT-R6-010 - Answer A: Wind alone cannot explain every example of desert pavement.

The passage explains that soil movement, settling dust, and rainwater can contribute alongside wind.

123. HSPT-R6-011 - Answer A: The reader considered the passage important.

The author specifically gives a pointing hand as evidence that a reader considered nearby lines important.

124. HSPT-R6-012 - Answer B: evidence left behind.

The traces are surviving marks that provide evidence of earlier readers' interactions with books.

125. HSPT-R6-013 - Answer D: To avoid making conclusions from uncertain evidence alone

Researchers combine several forms of evidence because individual marginal marks may have more than one possible interpretation.

126. HSPT-R6-014 - Answer C: It contrasts a passive image of books with evidence of active readers.

The image of untouched books contrasts with marginalia showing readers questioning, studying, and responding to texts.

127. HSPT-R6-015 - Answer C: To explain how marginalia can provide evidence about past readers

The passage explains what marginalia are, what they can reveal, and why researchers interpret them cautiously.

128. HSPT-R6-016 - Answer A: interested but appropriately cautious

The author emphasizes the value of marginalia while repeatedly acknowledging limits on what researchers can conclude.

129. HSPT-R6-017 - Answer D: There is almost no wind.

The passage states that the sky is still and even the leaves barely move.

130. HSPT-R6-018 - Answer A: She looks for useful work even when the original plan cannot proceed.

Elise begins testing ribbon arrangements instead of simply waiting for the wind.

131. HSPT-R6-019 - Answer A: how Noah uses an unexpected delay productively.

The calm weather prevents testing but gives the cousins time to improve the kite before the breeze arrives.

132. HSPT-R6-020 - Answer D: strengthened.

Reinforcing a bending corner means making it stronger so it can better resist damage.

133. HSPT-R6-021 - Answer C: An obstacle can create an opportunity to improve a plan.

The lack of wind delays flying but gives Noah and Elise time to improve the kite's design.

134. HSPT-R6-022 - Answer C: Returning freezing temperatures could damage the new growth.

The passage directly explains that a young shoot could be harmed if freezing weather returned.

135. HSPT-R6-023 - Answer D: Seed dormancy delays germination until conditions may be more favorable for growth.

The passage presents dormancy as a protective delay that can improve a seedling's chance of survival.

136. HSPT-R6-024 - Answer B: Immediate germination is not always advantageous for a seed.

Several examples show that delaying germination can prevent growth during unsafe or unfavorable conditions.

137. HSPT-R6-025 - Answer B: By defining dormancy, giving examples of triggers, and explaining its advantage
The passage first defines dormancy, then explains environmental triggers and why delayed germination can benefit plants.
138. HSPT-R6-026 - Answer C: Chemicals released by smoke
The passage specifically identifies heat or chemicals in smoke as germination triggers for certain seeds.
139. HSPT-R6-027 - Answer D: A doorway may once have existed there.
The passage explicitly identifies differently colored brick as possible evidence of a former doorway.
140. HSPT-R6-028 - Answer A: To explain how alterations and repairs can reveal a building's history
The passage focuses on interpreting physical changes to understand how people used and modified buildings.
141. HSPT-R6-029 - Answer B: To support or challenge interpretations of physical clues
Researchers compare several kinds of evidence because an unusual physical feature may have multiple explanations.
142. HSPT-R6-030 - Answer B: modify for a different purpose.
In context, adapting interiors means changing them so they can serve new uses.
143. HSPT-R6-031 - Answer C: It emphasizes that physical changes can provide evidence of human choices.
Calling the building a record highlights how alterations preserve evidence of decisions made by past users.
144. HSPT-R6-032 - Answer A: Changes to buildings, interpreted alongside other evidence, can reveal how structures were used over time.
This choice captures both the physical evidence and the need to interpret it using supporting records.
145. HSPT-R6-033 - Answer D: The path could change after storm tides.
The aunt explains that tides shift reeds and cover ground, making a fixed route potentially misleading.
146. HSPT-R6-034 - Answer A: She wants evidence about the route's current condition.
Her observations help determine whether the route is currently safe and accurately represented.
147. HSPT-R6-035 - Answer D: without warning.
The map line stops suddenly at a question mark, so abruptly means without warning or a gradual ending.
148. HSPT-R6-036 - Answer C: The value of acknowledging changing conditions
By the end, Nia sees the question mark as useful evidence that the route may not remain fixed.
149. HSPT-R6-037 - Answer B: Accurate information sometimes includes uncertainty.
The unfinished map is useful precisely because it honestly represents a route that may change.
150. HSPT-R6-038 - Answer A: The messenger actor has lost his voice.
The director asks Elias to read temporarily so rehearsal can continue after the actor loses his voice.
151. HSPT-R6-039 - Answer C: Timing onstage can explain why certain lighting cues feel rushed.
Speaking lets Elias experience how dialogue and movement interact with his lighting timing.
152. HSPT-R6-040 - Answer D: To show that his brief stage experience improved rather than replaced his original interest
Elias gains insight from acting but remains committed to the technical role he already values.
153. HSPT-R6-041 - Answer B: A problem is introduced, a character tries an unfamiliar role, and the experience changes his understanding.
The lost voice creates a problem that leads Elias into a new experience and a changed perspective.
154. HSPT-R6-042 - Answer A: Understanding another role can improve one's performance in a different role.
Elias becomes better at lighting because briefly acting reveals how stage timing affects his cues.
155. HSPT-R6-043 - Answer A: To allow bridge sections to move slightly
The passage states that expansion joints permit neighboring bridge sections to move without pressing dangerously together.
156. HSPT-R6-044 - Answer C: carefully limited or managed.
The movement is intentionally allowed within safe limits, so controlled means carefully managed.
157. HSPT-R6-045 - Answer B: Its materials may undergo greater expansion and contraction.
Because temperature affects material size, larger temperature swings can produce more structural movement.
158. HSPT-R6-046 - Answer D: It explains additional demands placed on expansion joints and why maintenance matters.
The paragraph adds traffic, debris, water, and maintenance demands beyond temperature-related movement.
159. HSPT-R6-047 - Answer B: Engineers use planned flexibility to help bridges handle movement and remain durable.
The passage explains how controlled movement can protect a bridge rather than weaken it.
160. HSPT-R6-048 - Answer C: He does not want to damage the lock.
Mateo stops before forcing the key, showing that he wants to avoid making the problem worse.
161. HSPT-R6-049 - Answer D: His judgment in seeking help before causing damage
Mr. Ibarra praises Mateo specifically for recognizing when to stop and ask for assistance.

162. HSPT-R6-050 - Answer A: symbolized.

The key represented, or symbolized, the trust Mr. Ibarra had placed in Mateo.

163. HSPT-R6-051 - Answer B: It changes from a sign of trust to a reminder about responsible judgment.

Mateo first values the key as authority, then connects it with knowing when to seek help.

164. HSPT-R6-052 - Answer C: Responsibility includes recognizing when assistance is needed.

The story shows that responsible action can involve stopping and requesting help rather than forcing a solution.

165. HSPT-R6-053 - Answer B: To make a shared environmental cause easier to identify

Similar patterns across many trees make a regional environmental influence more likely than an individual-tree cause.

166. HSPT-R6-054 - Answer D: continue farther back.

Matching old and living wood allows the regional record to continue farther into the past.

167. HSPT-R6-055 - Answer B: Tree-ring evidence becomes stronger when patterns and other records agree.

The passage stresses comparison among trees and combination with other evidence to strengthen interpretation.

168. HSPT-R6-056 - Answer B: It introduces tree rings, explains how they are interpreted, and describes why comparison improves the evidence.

The passage moves from basic ring formation to interpretation and then to methods for strengthening conclusions.

169. HSPT-R6-057 - Answer D: the surrounding information needed to interpret evidence.

Context refers to other relevant conditions and evidence needed to understand what a ring pattern may mean.

170. HSPT-R6-058 - Answer C: It required mechanics to make repeated adjustments before installation.

Mechanics repeatedly filed the original bracket by hand before they could install it.

171. HSPT-R6-059 - Answer A: To emphasize that useful progress can occur without public recognition

The unnoticed bracket improvement supports the passage's argument that progress often comes from modest practical changes.

172. HSPT-R6-060 - Answer B: It serves as an example supporting a broader idea about technological progress.

Venn's experience illustrates how observation and small refinements can contribute to broader technological development.

173. HSPT-R6-061 - Answer C: admiring but measured

The author values Venn's careful work without exaggerating its importance or presenting it as a dramatic invention.

174. HSPT-R6-062 - Answer D: To show how small, practical improvements can contribute to technological progress

The final paragraph explicitly broadens Venn's modest improvement into a point about how progress can occur.

Mathematics

175. HSPT-M6-001 - Answer A: $7/12$

$7/12 \approx 0.583$, which is greater than 0.57, 0.56, and 0.55.

176. HSPT-M6-002 - Answer A: 6

$2 \frac{1}{4} = 9/4$, and $9/4 \div 3/8 = 9/4 \times 8/3 = 6$.

177. HSPT-M6-003 - Answer D: 72

72 is the smallest number containing all prime factors needed for divisibility by 8, 12, and 18.

178. HSPT-M6-004 - Answer C: 18.75%

The decrease is \$12, and $12 \div 64 = 0.1875 = 18.75\%$.

179. HSPT-M6-005 - Answer D: 17

Substitute $x = 6$: $y = 4(6) - 7 = 24 - 7 = 17$.

180. HSPT-M6-006 - Answer A: $10n - 11$

Distribute 5 to obtain $10n - 15$, then add 4 to get $10n - 11$.

181. HSPT-M6-007 - Answer B: 45

The rate is $18 \div 6 = 3$ parts per minute, so $3 \times 15 = 45$.

182. HSPT-M6-008 - Answer A: $p > 7$

Add 9 to obtain $4p > 28$, then divide by 4 to get $p > 7$.

183. HSPT-M6-009 - Answer A: 11 cm

A regular octagon has eight equal sides, so each side is $88 \div 8 = 11$ cm.

184. HSPT-M6-010 - Answer C: 15 units

Using the Pythagorean relationship, $\sqrt{(9^2 + 12^2)} = \sqrt{225} = 15$.

185. HSPT-M6-011 - Answer D: 36π cm²

Circle area is πr^2 , so $\pi(6^2) = 36\pi$ cm².

186. HSPT-M6-012 - Answer B: 18 miles per hour

Average speed equals distance divided by time: $27 \div 1.5 = 18$ miles per hour.

187. HSPT-M6-013 - Answer C: 2,400

One liter equals 1,000 milliliters, so 2.4 liters equals 2,400 milliliters.

188. HSPT-M6-014 - Answer A: 19

Five values with mean 17 total 85; the known values total 66, so $x = 19$.

189. HSPT-M6-015 - Answer D: $7/12$

Seven of the 12 tiles are white or gray, so the probability of selecting a nonblack tile is $7/12$.

190. HSPT-M6-016 - Answer D: The mode is 14.

The value 14 occurs three times, more often than any other number in the set.

191. HSPT-M6-017 - Answer A: 15

$|-8| = 8$ and $|3 - 10| = |-7| = 7$, so the sum is 15.

192. HSPT-M6-018 - Answer D: $3/8$

$0.375 = 375/1000$, which simplifies to $3/8$.

193. HSPT-M6-019 - Answer C: 61

61 has no positive factors other than 1 and 61, while the other choices are divisible by 3.

194. HSPT-M6-020 - Answer C: 6

Subtracting $3x$ gives $4x - 5 = 19$; adding 5 gives $4x = 24$, so $x = 6$.

195. HSPT-M6-021 - Answer A: 21

Substitute 5 into the rule: $f(5) = 5^2 - 4 = 25 - 4 = 21$.

196. HSPT-M6-022 - Answer B: $4w + 10$

The perimeter is $2w + 2(w + 5)$, which simplifies to $4w + 10$.

197. HSPT-M6-023 - Answer C: $84 - 6h$

The tank begins with 84 gallons and loses 6 gallons for each hour h .

198. HSPT-M6-024 - Answer B: 56°

Supplementary angles total 180° , so the missing angle is $180 - 124 = 56^\circ$.

199. HSPT-M6-025 - Answer B: 202 cm²
Surface area is $2(4 \times 5 + 4 \times 9 + 5 \times 9) = 2(20 + 36 + 45) = 202 \text{ cm}^2$.
200. HSPT-M6-026 - Answer C: 20 cm
The scale factor is $15 \div 6 = 2.5$, so $8 \times 2.5 = 20 \text{ cm}$.
201. HSPT-M6-027 - Answer D: 9:05 p.m.
Adding 2 hours gives 8:47 p.m.; adding 18 more minutes gives 9:05 p.m.
202. HSPT-M6-028 - Answer C: 90 inches
Seven feet equals 84 inches; adding 6 inches gives 90 inches.
203. HSPT-M6-029 - Answer D: 63 miles
Multiply the map distance by the scale: $3.5 \times 18 = 63 \text{ miles}$.
204. HSPT-M6-030 - Answer A: 25
With six values, the median is the average of the third and fourth values: $(23 + 27) \div 2 = 25$.
205. HSPT-M6-031 - Answer A: $\frac{1}{4}$
The multiples of 3 are 3 and 6, giving 2 favorable outcomes out of 8, or $\frac{1}{4}$.
206. HSPT-M6-032 - Answer B: The groups have the same mean and median.
Both groups total 60 for a mean of 12, and each has a median of 12.
207. HSPT-M6-033 - Answer A: $1 \frac{7}{12}$
Using twelfths, $\frac{3}{4} = \frac{9}{12}$ and $\frac{5}{6} = \frac{10}{12}$; the sum is $\frac{19}{12} = 1 \frac{7}{12}$.
208. HSPT-M6-034 - Answer C: $2 \times (7 + 2)$
Evaluate parentheses first: $7 + 2 = 9$, then $2 \times 9 = 18$.
209. HSPT-M6-035 - Answer A: 10
 $|-14| = 14$ and $|5 - 9| = 4$, so $14 - 4 = 10$.
210. HSPT-M6-036 - Answer D: 70
The added 21 marbles represent $\frac{3}{10}$ of capacity, so full capacity is $21 \div 0.3 = 70$.
211. HSPT-M6-037 - Answer B: 29
Substitute 4: $2(4^2) - 3 = 32 - 3 = 29$.
212. HSPT-M6-038 - Answer D: $2t - 5$
Twice t is $2t$, and five less than that is $2t - 5$.
213. HSPT-M6-039 - Answer C: 6
Subtract the \$4 starting fee: \$15 remains; $\$15 \div \$2.50 = 6 \text{ miles}$.
214. HSPT-M6-040 - Answer B: 6 cm
Let width be w : $2[(2w + 3) + w] = 42$, so $6w + 6 = 42$ and $w = 6$.
215. HSPT-M6-041 - Answer D: 142°
Supplementary angles total 180° , so $180^\circ - 38^\circ = 142^\circ$.
216. HSPT-M6-042 - Answer D: 72 cm²
The trapezoid area is $\frac{1}{2}(9 + 15) \times 6 = 72 \text{ cm}^2$.
217. HSPT-M6-043 - Answer B: 158 cm²
Surface area is $2(3 \times 5 + 3 \times 8 + 5 \times 8) = 2(15 + 24 + 40) = 158 \text{ cm}^2$.
218. HSPT-M6-044 - Answer C: 63 miles
Multiply the map distance by the scale: $3.5 \times 18 = 63 \text{ miles}$.
219. HSPT-M6-045 - Answer D: 6.25
Thirty minutes is 2.5 times 12 minutes, so distance is $2.5 \times 2.5 = 6.25 \text{ kilometers}$.
220. HSPT-M6-046 - Answer C: $x \geq 13$
Since 13 is the third ordered value, the fourth value x must be at least 13.
221. HSPT-M6-047 - Answer A: $\frac{3}{8}$
The favorable outcomes are 4, 6, and 8, giving 3 favorable outcomes out of 8.
222. HSPT-M6-048 - Answer B: 16
Six scores total $6 \times 14 = 84$; the five known scores total 68, leaving 16.
223. HSPT-M6-049 - Answer C: $\frac{5}{8}$
 $\frac{5}{8} = 0.625$, which is greater than 0.62, 0.61, and 0.605.
224. HSPT-M6-050 - Answer C: 36
The least positive number divisible by both 12 and 18 is 36.

225. HSPT-M6-051 - Answer B: 2.25
One fourth equals 0.25, so $2\frac{1}{4}$ equals 2.25.
226. HSPT-M6-052 - Answer A: 3
Substitute $a = 5$: $4(5) + 3b = 29$, so $20 + 3b = 29$ and $b = 3$.
227. HSPT-M6-053 - Answer B: $x < 5$
Subtract 7 to get $3x < 15$, then divide by 3 to obtain $x < 5$.
228. HSPT-M6-054 - Answer B: $p = 3m$
The rate is $18 \div 6 = 3$ parts per minute, so $p = 3m$.
229. HSPT-M6-055 - Answer A: $y = 4x + 3$
 y increases by 4 when x increases by 1, and substituting $x = 1$ gives $y = 7$.
230. HSPT-M6-056 - Answer B: 15 cm
By the Pythagorean theorem, $\sqrt{9^2 + 12^2} = \sqrt{225} = 15$.
231. HSPT-M6-057 - Answer C: 113.04 cm²
Area is $\pi r^2 = 3.14 \times 6^2 = 3.14 \times 36 = 113.04$ cm².
232. HSPT-M6-058 - Answer C: 15 cm
The scale factor is $9 \div 6 = 1.5$, so $10 \times 1.5 = 15$ cm.
233. HSPT-M6-059 - Answer D: 12
One quart equals 4 cups, so 3 quarts equal $3 \times 4 = 12$ cups.
234. HSPT-M6-060 - Answer B: 2 hours 34 minutes
From 6:38 P.M. to 8:38 P.M. is 2 hours, and from 8:38 P.M. to 9:12 P.M. is 34 minutes.
235. HSPT-M6-061 - Answer D: 5
7.5 feet equals 90 inches; $90 \div 18 = 5$ complete pieces.
236. HSPT-M6-062 - Answer A: $1/16$
The probability of blue each time is $3/12 = 1/4$; with replacement, $1/4 \times 1/4 = 1/16$.
237. HSPT-M6-063 - Answer D: both median and range
The median changes from 9.5 to 11, and the range changes from 11 to 14.
238. HSPT-M6-064 - Answer B: 30%
Fifteen of 50 students chose sports, and $15 \div 50 = 0.30 = 30\%$.

Language

239. HSPT-L6-001 - Answer C: After checking the weather, Tessa packed a light jacket.

A comma correctly follows the introductory phrase "After checking the weather."

240. HSPT-L6-002 - Answer C: The two pilots checked the plane's engine.

Plane's is the singular possessive form showing that the engine belongs to one plane.

241. HSPT-L6-003 - Answer D: The recipe requires four ingredients: flour, yeast, water, and salt.

A colon correctly follows a complete independent clause introducing a list.

242. HSPT-L6-004 - Answer A: Our class studied the Pacific Ocean during science.

Pacific Ocean is a proper geographic name, while science is a general school subject and remains lowercase.

243. HSPT-L6-005 - Answer A: In October, Dr. Ramos will speak at the National History Center.

The month, title with name, and complete organization name are properly capitalized.

244. HSPT-L6-006 - Answer D: maintenance

Maintenance is the standard US English spelling of the word.

245. HSPT-L6-007 - Answer C: Her explanation was completely independant of mine.

"Independant" is misspelled; the correct spelling is "independent."

246. HSPT-L6-008 - Answer A: Neither of the lanterns is bright enough.

Neither is singular in this construction and correctly takes the singular verb is.

247. HSPT-L6-009 - Answer C: The coach gave the instructions to Maya and me.

Me is the correct objective pronoun because it is part of the object of the preposition to.

248. HSPT-L6-010 - Answer B: The internship requires arriving on time, following directions, and completing daily records.

All three items use parallel gerund phrases, creating a grammatically balanced series.

249. HSPT-L6-011 - Answer B: The technician secured the loose wire before testing the circuit.

Secured precisely describes fastening or making the loose wire safe before testing.

250. HSPT-L6-012 - Answer A: The outcome surprised everyone.

This version removes redundant expressions such as "final outcome," "at the end," and "each and every."

251. HSPT-L6-013 - Answer A: Sentence 4

The material used for decorative clock cases does not contribute to the paragraph's explanation of restoring the mechanism.

252. HSPT-L6-014 - Answer C: Restoring a mechanical clock requires careful attention to both its operation and original parts.

This sentence introduces both central concerns developed throughout the passage: mechanical function and preservation of original workmanship.

253. HSPT-L6-015 - Answer D: Between sentences 1 and 2

The added sentence logically introduces the need to understand the mechanism before sentence 2 describes examining and recording its arrangement.

254. HSPT-L6-016 - Answer A: The storm ended; however, the roads remained flooded.

A semicolon correctly separates the independent clauses, and commas set off the conjunctive adverb however.

255. HSPT-L6-017 - Answer B: "Please close the window," Mr. Vega said.

In standard US punctuation, the comma belongs inside the closing quotation mark before the dialogue tag.

256. HSPT-L6-018 - Answer D: We traveled south on River Road before turning onto Oak Avenue.

Directional south is lowercase, while the complete street names River Road and Oak Avenue are capitalized.

257. HSPT-L6-019 - Answer B: My cousin speaks Spanish and is learning French.

Language names are proper nouns and must be capitalized, while cousin remains lowercase.

258. HSPT-L6-020 - Answer A: occasion

Occasion is the standard spelling, with double c and a single s.

259. HSPT-L6-021 - Answer B: The machine required frequent lubrification.

"Lubrification" is misspelled; the correct word is "lubrication."

260. HSPT-L6-022 - Answer C: The audience applauded the performance enthusiastically.

Every word in this sentence is spelled correctly.

261. HSPT-L6-023 - Answer A: By the time we arrived, the train had already left.

Past perfect correctly identifies the train's departure as occurring before the later past action of arriving.

262. HSPT-L6-024 - Answer A: Because the road was closed for repairs, the bus followed a detour.
This choice combines the dependent clause with an independent clause to form a complete sentence.
263. HSPT-L6-025 - Answer C: Lena photographed the branches covered in frost.
The phrase "covered in frost" is placed beside branches, the noun it logically modifies.
264. HSPT-L6-026 - Answer B: The new schedule will affect when the buses depart.
Affect is the verb meaning to influence, which is the required meaning in this sentence.
265. HSPT-L6-027 - Answer C: Elena had been helpful, so Priya thanked her.
The pronoun her clearly refers to Elena without creating uncertainty about which person is meant.
266. HSPT-L6-028 - Answer D: Sentence 4
The club's regular meeting location does not contribute to the passage's focus on planning and building the observation platform.
267. HSPT-L6-029 - Answer A: Next,
Next clearly signals another step in the chronological sequence of constructing the observation area.
268. HSPT-L6-030 - Answer B: Finally, students created a schedule for evening use, helping make the finished platform safer and more organized.
This revision efficiently combines the scheduling action with its contribution to the platform's organization and usefulness.
269. HSPT-L6-031 - Answer B: The storm ended; however, the roads remained flooded.
A semicolon correctly joins the independent clauses, and a comma follows the conjunctive adverb however.
270. HSPT-L6-032 - Answer C: "Please label each sample," said Dr. Chen.
In US English, the comma closing the spoken words appears inside the quotation marks before the dialogue tag.
271. HSPT-L6-033 - Answer C: The hikers carried three essentials: water, maps, and flashlights.
A colon correctly introduces the list after the complete clause.
272. HSPT-L6-034 - Answer B: My cousin studies French and algebra at Lincoln Middle School.
Languages and the full school name are capitalized; a general subject such as algebra is lowercase.
273. HSPT-L6-035 - Answer B: On Memorial Day, we visited Aunt Rosa in the West.
The holiday, family title used with a name, and recognized regional term West are capitalized.
274. HSPT-L6-036 - Answer D: occurrence
Occurrence is correctly spelled with double c and double r.
275. HSPT-L6-037 - Answer C: The witness gave a consistant account.
Consistant is misspelled; the correct standard spelling is consistent.
276. HSPT-L6-038 - Answer D: Each of the volunteers brings a reusable bottle.
Each is singular and therefore takes the singular verb brings.
277. HSPT-L6-039 - Answer B: Lena photographed the window covered in frost.
The phrase covered in frost logically modifies window and is placed directly after it.
278. HSPT-L6-040 - Answer B: By the time the bus arrived, Marco had waited for twenty minutes.
Past perfect had waited correctly describes an action completed before another past event.
279. HSPT-L6-041 - Answer D: The new policy may affect how supplies are ordered.
Affect is the verb meaning to influence, which fits the sentence.
280. HSPT-L6-042 - Answer C: Ava spoke to Priya while carrying the model.
This revision clearly identifies Ava as the person carrying the model.
281. HSPT-L6-043 - Answer D: However
However signals the contrast between the prototype's advantage and its weakness.
282. HSPT-L6-044 - Answer D: Sentence 5
The bicycle detail does not contribute to the description of the temperature investigation.
283. HSPT-L6-045 - Answer A: For five days, the students measured the same locations at the same times and recorded each site's shade conditions and ground material.
This version combines both ideas clearly and concisely while preserving the original meaning.
284. HSPT-L6-046 - Answer D: Before leaving the laboratory, Maya checked every cabinet.
A comma correctly follows the introductory phrase before the independent clause.
285. HSPT-L6-047 - Answer C: The two players' uniforms were hanging in the locker room.
The uniforms belong to two players, so the apostrophe follows the plural noun players.

286. HSPT-L6-048 - Answer A: Professor Lin will speak at the National Science Museum on Tuesday.
The title with a name, full institution name, and day of the week are properly capitalized.
287. HSPT-L6-049 - Answer B: We crossed the Mississippi River before entering Arkansas.
Mississippi River and Arkansas are proper geographic names and require capitalization.
288. HSPT-L6-050 - Answer A: occasionally
Occasionally is spelled with two c's and two l's.
289. HSPT-L6-051 - Answer A: The instructions were completely neccessary.
Neccessary is misspelled; the correct spelling is necessary.
290. HSPT-L6-052 - Answer D: The principal announced a temporary schedule change.
Every word in this sentence is spelled correctly.
291. HSPT-L6-053 - Answer C: The coach gave the certificates to Jordan and me.
The pronoun is the object of the preposition to, so the objective form me is required.
292. HSPT-L6-054 - Answer D: The job requires measuring parts, recording results, and cleaning equipment.
All three items use parallel gerund forms: measuring, recording, and cleaning.
293. HSPT-L6-055 - Answer B: The team postponed practice until the field dried.
This choice contains a subject and predicate and expresses a complete thought.
294. HSPT-L6-056 - Answer D: Fewer trees were damaged than expected.
Fewer is correctly used with the countable plural noun trees.
295. HSPT-L6-057 - Answer B: The meeting was delayed because the manager arrived late.
This sentence states the cause directly without redundant phrases such as reason because or due to the fact that.
296. HSPT-L6-058 - Answer D: Nevertheless
Nevertheless signals the contrast between the difficult trail and the hikers' successful early arrival.
297. HSPT-L6-059 - Answer A: After sentence 2
The sentence states the goal immediately after the original problem and before the new system is introduced.
298. HSPT-L6-060 - Answer C: The adjustment did not eliminate every delay, but it reduced the crowding that the staff had observed.
This revision connects the adjustment to a specific result and leads logically into the concluding idea.